

B10 Practice Platform

Instructor Reference Binder

ESO/Frames Practice Platform
ILR 2+ / 3 Oral English Proficiency

Room 2236

Defense Language Institute English Language Center

Pilot Launch
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Point of Contact
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Daily Quick Reference

Morning Debrief · Enabling Activity · ESO Debrief · End-of-Class Assignment

Step 1 CORE Debrief Policy + Topic-Seed	Step 2 Enabling Activity 10–15 min · Frame Practice	Step 3 ESO Debrief Bundle + Frames ESO	Step 4 Assign Tomorrow Bundle + MTS + Frames ESO
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Step 1 CORE Bundle — Morning Debrief

- 1 Confirm submissions**
 Check instructor dashboard. Follow up with non-submitters privately.
- 2 Memory Training Strategy (MTS) pair debrief**
 - Restate last night's MTS in one sentence
 - Students pair for 3–4 minutes and discuss:
 - Did the strategy help retain the main idea?
 - Where did retrieval break down?
 - What would they do differently next time?
 - One pair briefs back to the class
- 3 Select a 3/4 or 4/4 exemplar**
 Instructor-selected (default) or volunteer at discretion.
- 4 Play audio**
 - 4a** Play the policy CORE audio passage
 - 4b** Play the selected student response audio
- 5 Discuss transcript and platform feedback**
 - Was the main idea captured accurately?
 - Which details were retained? Which were missing?
 - What specific language made the response clear or precise?
 - Display platform scaffold feedback — what did it identify? Does the class agree?
 - Besides the main idea, what details, if any, were identified?
 - What would the student need to do differently on the next attempt?
- 6 Connect to the score**
 Reference the score on the dashboard. Name specifically what earned it.

■ Repeat Steps 3–6 for the topic-seed CORE audio.

Note: Each nightly bundle contains two CORE passages — policy audio and topic-seed audio. Both mandatory, scored identically, debriefed the same way.

Step 2 · 10–15 min Enabling Activity — Frame Practice

Select one activity from the current week's enabling activities set. Activities build from surface/declarative (1a) to procedural/automatic transfer (4c) across the week.

Day 1 Activity 1a Depth Ladder	Day 2 Activity 1b Sentence-Frame Progression	Day 3 Activity 1c Comparison & Paraphrase	Day 4 Activity 4a 2-Box Induction	Day 5 Activity 4b or 4c Silent Protocol or Strategic Competence
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Refer to the current week's Enabling Activities document for full instructions.

Step 3**ESO/Frames — Morning Debrief****1 Confirm submissions**

Check instructor dashboard. Follow up with non-submitters privately.

2 Select a 3/4 or 4/4 exemplar

Instructor-selected (default) or volunteer at discretion.

3 Play audio

3a Play the ESO question audio

3b Play the selected student response audio

4 Discuss transcript and platform feedback

- Which of the three frame steps are clearly present?
- What specific language carried the argument at each step?
- Display platform scaffold feedback — what did it identify? Does the class agree?
- Evaluate the middle step — was it explicit and developed? If yes, what made it land? If not, what would strengthen it?
- What would the student need to do differently on the next attempt?

4a Optional repeat — additional response on same ESO question

- Instructor selects or solicits a volunteer response
- Play audio and display transcript
- Focus: what did this response do differently at the middle step, or in spiral integration, compared to the first?

5 Address spiral integration (Week 2+)

- Did prior frames appear?
- Were they woven organically into the argument or appended?
- If yes, what made the integration effective? If not, which prior frame would have strengthened the argument and where?

■ Repeat Steps 2–5 for the Frames ESO question.

Step 4**Assign Tomorrow's Pre-Class Work****1 Assign the next bundle in sequence**

Navigate to the assignment panel. Assign the next bundle (e.g. S1.2, S2.3). Policy audio, topic-seed audio, and domain-linked ESO are pre-packaged.

2 Designate tonight's MTS

State it by name and restate its core strategy in one sentence. Remind students: one listen, immediate spoken response, no notes.

3 Assign the Frames ESO question

- **Day 1:** 1–2 most accessible questions · full scaffold
- **Day 2:** 2 moderate questions · full scaffold
- **Day 3:** 1–2 increasing difficulty · scaffold fading
- **Day 4:** student selects 1–2 · cold production
- **Day 5:** weekend bridge from general ESO bank · combo scaffold

4 Set expectations

Inform students that a strong response from tonight's attempt will be played and discussed tomorrow.

Student Onboarding

Day 1 Enrollment & Orientation Procedure

Use on Day 1 whenever a new student or class begins on B10-PP. If students are already enrolled and familiar with the platform, skip this procedure.

PRE-CLASS Before the Session

1 Confirm student enrollment

Verify each student has been added to your roster using their B10-PP ID via the admin panel. Students cannot self-enroll.

DAY 1 In-Class Procedure

2 Direct students to the platform

Navigate to: b10-practice-platform.web.app/b10_practice_platform/ — students log in with their B10-PP ID and password.

3 Credential security — state this clearly

Instruct students to write down their B10-PP ID and password and store them securely.

■ **Passwords cannot be reset. Loss of credentials requires re-enrollment by the instructor.**

4 B10-PP ID is a permanent credential

The B10-PP ID is the student's permanent identifier across all tracks and future courses — required for SLT sessions, Main Instructor transitions, and re-enrollment. Not a one-time login.

5 Orient students to the platform interface

Cover three areas: (1) Passage navigation — finding and opening assigned passages. (2) Recording screen — how to record a response. (3) Scores and feedback — where to find results after submission.

PROCEED After Orientation

6 Proceed to the Day 1 frame launch

Once students are logged in and oriented, follow the ESO/Frames Daily Protocol SOP — Day 1 procedure. Treat this week as a single-frame week with no spiral requirement.

URL: b10-practice-platform.web.app/b10_practice_platform/

Login: B10-PP ID + password (cannot be reset)

Enrollment issues: Contact B10-PP administrator

CORE Bundle Practice — Daily Protocol

Role: Main Instructor | Track: CORE Bundle | Version 1.0 | Effective: July 27, 2026

1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This SOP governs the daily instructional cycle for the CORE Bundle track of the B10 Practice Platform (B10-PP). It applies to all Main Instructors assigned to classes in which students are completing CORE Bundle assignments as part of ILR 2+/3 oral English proficiency development.

This document covers two interlocking instructor actions: the evening assignment (assigning tonight's bundle to students) and the morning debrief (reviewing the previous night's attempts with the class). These two actions form a single instructional cycle. The instructor is always working one day ahead: today's debrief addresses last night's assignment; today's assignment prepares tomorrow's debrief.

DESIGN RATIONALE

CORE Bundle passages are completed by students independently, outside of class. The platform records their spoken responses and scores them automatically. The instructor's role during class time is not to supervise recording — it is to debrief the attempt and build proficiency through structured review, peer comparison, and targeted discussion of what separates a scored 3/4 from a scored 4/4 response.

2. WHAT YOU ARE DOING RIGHT NOW

Position	When	Your Task	Go to Section
Morning Debrief	Start of class — students completed a bundle the night before	Review submissions, lead structured debrief, facilitate peer sharing	Section 4
Evening Assignment	End of class — you are assigning tonight's bundle	Assign bundle via dashboard, brief students, set MTS focus	Section 5

NOTE

On Day 1 of a new class or a new student group, there is no prior attempt to debrief. Begin with Section 5 (Evening Assignment) and return to Section 4 starting on Day 2.

3. PLATFORM OVERVIEW — CORE BUNDLE

CORE Bundle passages are ILR-level 3 English texts (approximately 70–85 words) drawn from academic, professional, and policy domains. Students listen to the passage once via the platform, then record an immediate spoken paraphrase. The platform scores each attempt on a 1–4 integer scale using the REDS rubric framework (Random, Emerging, Developing, Sustained). Scores are visible to both student and instructor via the platform dashboard.

The core proficiency demand: Students must retain and immediately reproduce the main idea plus supporting details from a single listening, without notes. This is a high cognitive load task — particularly for paraphrase of propositional density at ILR 3 — and is the primary proficiency target of this track.

MEMORY TRAINING STRATEGIES (MTS)

Memory Training Strategies are student-facing HTML reference documents available in the CORE Bundle Reference Materials folder on the platform. Each document presents a specific listening and retention strategy for students to apply during their bundle attempt. Each nightly assignment includes a designated MTS. See Section 5, Step 3 for the assignment procedure and Section 4, Steps 3a–3b for the morning debrief procedure.

4. MORNING DEBRIEF PROCEDURE

You are at the start of class. Students completed a CORE Bundle assignment the previous evening. Proceed in the following order.

1 Confirm submissions via instructor dashboard.

Open the B10-PP instructor dashboard. Verify that student submissions for the assigned bundle have been received. Note any students who did not submit — follow up privately; do not address publicly at this stage.

2 Announce the debrief focus.

State the passage title or ID from last night's bundle. Briefly restate the proficiency demand: *"Last night you listened once and paraphrased. Today we are looking at what made the strongest responses strong."*

3 **Select an exemplar response (Option A — Instructor-Selected).**

From the dashboard, identify one student response scored 3/4 or 4/4. Select a response that clearly illustrates the main idea plus strong detail retention. This is the default debrief method. Proceed to Step 4.

INSTRUCTOR DISCRETION — OPTION B (VOLUNTEER)

As an alternative or on a subsequent day, invite a student volunteer to share their response. Option B surfaces a wider range of responses — including those with productive gaps — and generates student-led discussion. Option B is most effective after the class has already heard an exemplar via Option A and has a calibration reference. Consider alternating: Option A on Day 1 of a new bundle set, Option B on Day 2 or 3.

4 **Play the selected audio response to the class.**

Use the instructor dashboard to play the selected student's audio. Instruct students to listen actively — they are not evaluating the speaker, they are identifying what information was retained and how it was expressed.

5 **Display and discuss the transcript.**

After playing the audio, display or read the transcript. Lead a brief class discussion using the following anchoring questions: (1) Was the main idea captured accurately? (2) Which details were retained? Which were missing? (3) What specific language made this response clear or precise? (4) What would move this response from a 3 to a 4, or confirm it as a 4?

6 **Connect to scoring explicitly.**

Reference the score displayed on the dashboard for the exemplar response. Name what the score reflects. Avoid vague praise — be specific about what linguistic or content feature earned the score shown.

MTS PAIR DEBRIEF — STEPS 3A AND 3B

(3a) Announce the MTS assigned last night and restate its core strategy in one sentence. Students pair with a partner for 3–4 minutes to debrief efficacy — what worked, where retrieval broke down.

(3b) One pair briefs back to the class before the exemplar is played. Default: instructor assigns a specific MTS for each night. Student-selected MTS is available at instructor discretion after all MTS types have been introduced.

5. EVENING ASSIGNMENT PROCEDURE

You are at or near the end of class. You are assigning tonight's CORE Bundle. Proceed in the following order.

- 1 Select the bundle via the instructor dashboard.**
Navigate to the student's assignment panel. Select the CORE Bundle for tonight's practice. Assign to the full class roster or to specific students as appropriate.
- 2 Brief students on the assignment.**
State the passage ID or bundle title. Confirm the listening-and-paraphrase task format: one listen, immediate spoken response, no notes. Remind students that the platform records and scores automatically — they do not need to wait for instructor review before seeing their score.
- 3 Designate tonight's Memory Training Strategy (MTS).**
State the designated MTS by name and restate its core strategy in one sentence. Remind students to apply it during their attempt tonight. MTS reference documents are available in the CORE Bundle Reference Materials folder on the platform.
- 4 Set student expectations for tomorrow's debrief.**
Inform students that a strong response from tonight's attempt will be played and discussed tomorrow. Students who are willing to share their response should note this — or the instructor will select from submissions. This prepares students to engage in tomorrow's debrief as active participants, not passive listeners.

6. THE DAILY CYCLE AT A GLANCE

Phase	When	Instructor Action	Student Action
Assignment	End of class (today)	Assign bundle via dashboard; designate tonight's MTS; brief students	Complete bundle at home; apply designated MTS
Debrief	Start of class (next day)	Confirm submissions; select exemplar; lead discussion	MTS pair debrief; listen to exemplar; discuss

SCHEDULING NOTE

The assignment and debrief are separated by an overnight period. On any given class day, the instructor both debriefs last night's bundle (morning) and assigns tonight's bundle (end of class). These are distinct procedural events and should not be collapsed into a single activity.

7. SCORING REFERENCE

CORE Bundle responses are scored 1–4. The platform score is holistic, not a checklist. For debrief purposes, orient discussion around the following general descriptors:

Score	What It Reflects
4 / 4	Main idea accurately captured; strong detail retention; precise and varied language; response is coherent and well-organized
3 / 4	Main idea present; some supporting detail; language is adequate but may lack precision or range; minor gaps in coherence
2 / 4	Main idea partially captured or imprecise; limited detail; language constraints visible; response may be brief or fragmented
1 / 4	Main idea absent or significantly distorted; minimal or no detail; language significantly limits communication

INSTRUCTOR NOTE

Do not share score descriptors directly with students as a rubric. Scoring is holistic and instructor-mediated. Use these descriptors to guide your own selection of exemplar responses and to frame debrief discussion — not as a student-facing checklist.

8. ADMINISTRATIVE NOTES

- **Dashboard access:** Use the B10-PP instructor dashboard at b10-practice-platform.web.app/b10_practice_platform/. Log in with your assigned B10 instructor ID.
- **Submission window:** Student audio is retained on the platform for 72 hours. Plan debriefs within this window.
- **Non-submitting students:** Follow up privately. Do not delay the class debrief for missing submissions.
- **Score visibility:** Students see their own scores immediately after submission. Do not withhold scores — the platform is designed for immediate feedback. Your debrief adds interpretive value, not score gatekeeping.
- **Reference Materials folder:** Memory Training Strategy (MTS) reference documents are located in the CORE Bundle Reference Materials folder on the platform. Direct students to this folder at the start of the course and when introducing each new MTS.

ESO/Frames Practice — Daily Protocol

Role: Main Instructor | Track: ESO Discourse Frames | Version 1.0 | Effective: July 27, 2026

1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This SOP governs the daily instructional cycle for the ESO Discourse Frames track of the B10 Practice Platform (B10-PP). It applies to all Main Instructors assigned to classes in which students are completing ESO Frames practice as part of ILR 2+/3 oral English proficiency development.

The ESO Frames track is organized around a **6-week repeating cycle**, one discourse frame per week. Each week follows a **5-day arc** that moves students from fully scaffolded attempts on Day 1 toward independent, cold production by Day 5. The weekend bridge assignment at the end of each week consolidates that week's frame while beginning to spiral in previously learned frames.

This document is the primary procedural reference for daily classroom decisions. It is organized by day within the week. Consult Section 5 for the week-specific frame reference.

2. WHAT YOU ARE DOING RIGHT NOW

Identify your current position in the weekly arc and go directly to the corresponding section.

Day	Your Task	Go to Section
Day 1	Orientation (first week only) or launch new frame; assign D1 ESO questions	Section 3.1
Day 2	Debrief D1 attempts; assign D2 ESO questions; introduce spiral (W2+)	Section 3.2
Day 3	Debrief D2 attempts; begin scaffold fading; assign D3 questions	Section 3.3
Day 4	Debrief D3 attempts; student-selected questions; cold/near-cold production	Section 3.4
Day 5	Debrief D4 attempts; assign weekend bridge from ESO bank	Section 3.5

FIRST WEEK ON THIS TRACK

If this is a student's first week on the ESO Frames track — whether that is calendar Week 1 of the course or a later entry point — follow the Day 1 orientation procedure in Section 3.1 and treat this week as a single-frame week with no spiral requirement. The spiral begins in the student's second week on the track, regardless of which frame they started on.

3. DAILY PROCEDURES

Enabling Activities — Daily Frame Practice

Each class session includes a 10–15 minute enabling activity drawn from the current week's Enabling Activities set. Activities follow the weekly arc below, progressing from surface/declarative practice (Activity 1a) toward procedural/automatic transfer (Activity 4c). Repetition across the week is the mechanism by which frames become proceduralized.

Day	Activity	Focus
Day 1	Activity 1a	Depth Ladder — surface, scaffolded
Day 2	Activity 1b	Sentence-Frame Progression
Day 3	Activity 1c	Comparison & Paraphrase
Day 4	Activity 4a	2-Box Induction — pattern recognition
Day 5	Activity 4b or 4c	Silent Protocol or Strategic Competence — transfer

Refer to the current week's Enabling Activities document for full instructions. Adapted from: McDowell, M. (2026, June 30). Rigor redefined [Conference session]. ISTE 2026, Orange County Convention Center.

3.1 Day 1: Frame Launch

FIRST WEEK ON TRACK — ORIENTATION REQUIRED

If this is a student's or class's first week on the ESO Frames track, begin with the B10-PP enrollment and orientation procedure below before proceeding to the frame launch steps. If students are already enrolled and familiar with the platform, skip directly to Step 1.

B10-PP ENROLLMENT AND ORIENTATION (FIRST WEEK ONLY)

(1) Confirm that each student has been added to your roster using their assigned B10-PP ID. Students cannot self-enroll. (2) Direct students to the platform at b10-practice-platform.web.app and have them log in. (3) Instruct students to record their B10-PP ID and password and store them securely. Passwords cannot be reset. (4) The B10-PP ID is the permanent student identifier across all platform tracks. (5) Briefly orient students to the platform interface: passage navigation, the recording screen, and where to find scores and feedback. (6) Direct students to the ESO/Frames section and confirm they can locate the current week's Phrase Reference HTML and the Frames Argument Builder.

1 Introduce the week's discourse frame.

State the frame name and its three-step process (see Section 5 for the current week). Explain what kind of analytical move this frame requires. Keep the introduction to 3–5 minutes. Students develop understanding through practice, not through explanation.

2 Direct students to the week's Phrase Reference HTML.

Students open the current week's reference document in the ESO/Frames section of the platform. This is their primary scaffold for the week. Instruct them to read the frame description and review the sample questions and phrase chunks before attempting any ESO question.

3 Walk through the Frames Argument Builder together.

Open the Frames Argument Builder (available in the Frames Practice section). With the class, work through the three-step sequence for this week's frame using one of the Day 1 ESO questions as a model. Demonstrate the planning process only — identify each step, apply it to the question, stop before recording.

4 Assign Day 1 ESO questions (1–2 questions).

Assign 1–2 questions from the current week's ESO folder — select the most accessible questions in the set. Students complete these at home tonight. Full scaffold is in effect: the Phrase Reference HTML and Frames Argument Builder are open during planning. Students plan mentally using the three-step process. They do not write out their response before recording.

5 Set expectations for tomorrow's debrief.

Inform students that a strong response from tonight's attempt will be played and discussed tomorrow. Students willing to share should note this — or the instructor will select from submissions.

1 Confirm D1 submissions via instructor dashboard.

Verify submissions received. Note non-submitting students — follow up privately.

2 Select a D1 exemplar response (Option A — Instructor-Selected).

Identify a 3/4 or 4/4 response from last night's attempts. Select one that clearly engages all three steps of this week's frame. Play the audio to the class.

INSTRUCTOR DISCRETION — OPTION B (VOLUNTEER)

As an alternative or on a subsequent day, invite a student volunteer to share. Option B surfaces a range including responses with productive gaps. Most effective after the class has a calibration reference from Option A. Consider alternating across the week.

3 Display and discuss the transcript.

After playing the audio, lead discussion: (1) Which of the three frame steps are clearly present? (2) Where is the middle step most visible? Where is it missing or thin? (3) What specific language carried the argument at each step? (4) What would move this response from a 3 to a 4?

4 Introduce the spiral requirement (Week 2+ only).

Beginning in a student's second week on the track, students are expected to incorporate 1–2 prior frames alongside the current week's frame — 2–3 total active frames per response. A response that makes no attempt to integrate prior frames does not meet the standard for that week. Name the relevant prior frames to draw on (see Section 5).

5 Assign Day 2 ESO questions (2 questions).

Assign 2 questions from the current week's ESO folder of moderate difficulty. Full scaffold remains in effect. Remind students of the spiral requirement if applicable.

1 Confirm D2 submissions and debrief.

Follow the debrief procedure from Day 2, Steps 1–3. On Day 3, prioritize Option B (volunteer) if the class has not yet had a student-led debrief — students are now calibrated enough to evaluate each other's responses productively.

2 Introduce scaffold fading.

Explain to students that beginning tonight, the Phrase Reference HTML remains available as a reference but students should attempt to plan mentally before consulting it. The three-step sequence should now be internalized enough to apply without reading it line by line. Use the reference to confirm or recover, not to initiate.

3 Assign Day 3 ESO questions (1–2 questions).

Assign 1–2 questions of increasing difficulty from the weekly folder. Scaffold is fading: the Phrase Reference HTML is available but students plan mentally first. No written outline before recording.

4 Reinforce spiral explicitly. [*Spiral — Week 2+*]

Remind students that prior frames must appear in tonight's responses. Name the specific frames. A useful prompt: *"Before you record, identify which prior frame is most naturally activated by this question — then build it in."*

1 Confirm D3 submissions and debrief.

Follow the debrief procedure. On Day 4, focus discussion on spiral integration quality — not just whether prior frames appeared, but whether they were woven organically into the argument or felt appended.

2 Move to cold production.

Inform students that tonight's attempt is cold or near-cold: the Phrase Reference HTML is available only as a last resort. Students plan mentally — working through the frame's three steps and identifying relevant prior frames — before recording. No written notes, no open reference during planning.

3 Students select their own question(s) from the weekly folder.

Students choose 1–2 questions from the remaining questions in the current week's ESO folder. Attempting more than one question tonight is encouraged — this is the highest-volume production night of the week.

4 Reinforce spiral — cold integration. [*Spiral — Week 2+*]

Students are expected to integrate prior frames without prompting. Remind them: the planning pause before recording is the moment to select 1–2 prior frames the question most naturally activates and to decide how to sequence them. Three frames total — current week plus 1–2 prior — is the ceiling, not the floor.

1 Confirm D4 submissions and debrief.

Follow the debrief procedure. On Day 5, focus on cold production quality: did students demonstrate internalized frame structure without scaffolding? Did spiral frames appear organically? Select or solicit a response that illustrates both.

2 Assign the weekend bridge question.

Select one question from the general ESO bank — not from the current week's weekly folder. The question should be domain-appropriate and at ILR 3 difficulty. See Section 5 for a suggested weekend bridge question per week.

3 Assign the combo scaffold for the weekend bridge.

The weekend bridge always uses a two-frame scaffold combination: the current week's frame + one prior frame. State both frames explicitly. Instruct students to plan using both frame sequences from the Frames Argument Builder — the current week's frame as primary, the prior frame woven in. See Section 5 for the recommended scaffold combo per week.

4 Brief students on the weekend bridge purpose.

The weekend bridge is the first step in proceduralization. Students are not just practicing this week's frame — they are beginning to deploy frames in combination, which is what ILR 3 ESO production requires. Encountering an unfamiliar question from the general bank with a multi-frame scaffold is the closest simulation of actual test conditions this track provides.

4. THE WEEKLY ARC AT A GLANCE

Day	Scaffold Level	Questions	Source	Spiral
D1	Full — HTML + Argument Builder open	1–2 (most accessible)	Weekly folder	No (first week) / Yes (W2+)
D2	Full	2 (moderate)	Weekly folder	Yes (W2+)
D3	Fading — plan mentally; HTML to confirm	1–2 (increasing)	Weekly folder	Yes (W2+)
D4	Cold — HTML last resort only	Student selects 1–2; may attempt more	Weekly folder	Yes (W2+)
D5 (weekend)	Combo scaffold — current + 1 prior frame	1	General ESO bank	Yes — built into scaffold

ON THE SPIRAL — FUNDAMENTAL PRINCIPLE

Spiraling is not enrichment. It is the mechanism by which frames become proceduralized — available for deployment in any ESO context without conscious retrieval effort. A student in Week 4 who responds only with the Hypothetical & Conditional frame has not met the standard for that week. Students are expected to incorporate 1–2 prior frames alongside the current week's frame — 2–3 frames total per response. The goal is not exhaustiveness but selection: students choose the prior frames most naturally activated by the question and deploy them as integrated analytical moves, not as afterthoughts appended at the end.

5. WEEK-BY-WEEK FRAME REFERENCE

Each section below is self-contained for that week. It includes the three-step frame process, a sample ESO question from the weekly folder, the spiral requirement, and the recommended weekend bridge assignment.

WEEK 1 — Scale & Stakeholder

Stakeholder

Who is affected and at what level?

Impact

What specifically happens to them?

Scale Consideration

Why does operating at that level change the argument?

Key requirement: every response this week engages at least two scale levels (Individual & Family · Organizational & Community · National & Global). A response that stays at one scale level does not meet the standard for this frame.

Sample ESO Question — Weekly Folder

"Should companies be required to provide childcare for employees?"

Spiral requirement: None — this is the first frame. Students focus exclusively on Scale & Stakeholder this week.

Weekend bridge: Assign one question from the general ESO bank. Scaffold: Scale & Stakeholder only (no combo required for Week 1). Example: "Should governments prioritize economic growth over environmental protection?"

WEEK 2 — Trade-offs & Constraints

Benefit

What does the policy achieve?

Trade-off

What competing good is sacrificed?

Constraint

Why can't the trade-off simply be avoided?

Key requirement: naming a trade-off is insufficient — students must explain why the competing good cannot simply be preserved alongside the benefit. The constraint is structural, not incidental.

Sample ESO Question — Weekly Folder

"Should governments fund the arts during periods of economic austerity?"

Spiral requirement: Scale & Stakeholder (W1). Students identify who bears the trade-off and at what scale — this activates the W1 frame naturally within a trade-offs analysis.

Weekend bridge: General ESO bank. Combo scaffold: Trade-offs & Constraints (primary) + Scale & Stakeholder (secondary). Example: "Should foreign investment in farmland be restricted?"

WEEK 3 — Causal Systems

Trigger

What sets the causal chain in motion?

Mechanism

How does the effect actually get produced?

Downstream Effect

What results at the end of the chain?

Key requirement: the mechanism step is the analytical core. Students who jump from trigger to downstream effect without explaining the process by which the effect is produced are operating at ILR 2+, not ILR 3. The mechanism must be explicit.

Sample ESO Question — Weekly Folder

"Should governments regulate the use of artificial intelligence in hiring decisions?"

Spiral requirement: Draw on 1–2 prior frames (W1 and/or W2) as the question activates them. The causal chain naturally invites stakeholder identification (W1) and often surfaces a trade-off within the mechanism (W2). Students select whichever prior frame fits most organically — total active frames: 2–3.

Weekend bridge: General ESO bank. Combo scaffold: Causal Systems (primary) + Trade-offs & Constraints (secondary). Example: "Should countries ban single-use plastics?"

WEEK 4 — Hypothetical & Conditional

Condition

What must hold for this scenario to follow?

Projected Outcome

What would likely result?

Extended Scenario

And if that outcome holds, then what?

Key requirement: the extended scenario step requires students to project beyond the immediate outcome — to reason one step further. A response that stops at the projected outcome is a two-step response, not a three-step one.

Sample ESO Question — Weekly Folder

"Should universities eliminate standardized testing as an admissions requirement?"

Spiral requirement: Draw on 1–2 prior frames (W1, W2, or W3) as the question activates them. A strong response typically anchors the condition in specific stakeholders (W1) or names the trade-off embedded in the projected outcome (W2). Total active frames: 2–3.

Weekend bridge: General ESO bank. Combo scaffold: Hypothetical & Conditional (primary) + Causal Systems (secondary). Example: "Should governments provide a universal basic income?"

WEEK 5 — Values, Heuristics & Bias

Value

What does this stakeholder believe is important?

Assumption

What must be true for that value to justify their position?

Competing Framework

What does a stakeholder on the other side believe instead?

Key requirement: the assumption step is the analytical hinge. Naming a value is easy; identifying what must be empirically or normatively true for that value to justify the specific position taken is the ILR 3 move. Students must make the assumption explicit, not implied.

Sample ESO Question — Weekly Folder

"Should social media platforms be held legally responsible for content posted by users?"

Spiral requirement: All prior frames (W1–W4). The values analysis should be grounded in specific stakeholders (W1), name the trade-off between competing values (W2), trace the causal mechanism by which a value produces a policy position (W3), and frame the competing value as a conditional (W4).

Weekend bridge: General ESO bank. Combo scaffold: Values, Heuristics & Bias (primary) + Scale & Stakeholder (secondary). Example: "Should wealthy nations accept more refugees?"

WEEK 6 — Synthesis & Judgment

Tensions

What competing claims must be addressed?

Priorities

Which consideration carries more weight and why?

Judgment

What is the most defensible conclusion?

Key requirement: Week 6 is the integration frame — it does not replace prior frames, it organizes them. Tensions are named using prior frames. Priorities are argued, not asserted. The judgment is the most defensible conclusion given the tensions named — not a restatement of position.

Sample ESO Question — Weekly Folder

"Should governments prioritize national security over individual privacy rights?"

Spiral requirement: Draw on 1–2 prior frames (W1–W5) as the question activates them. The tensions named in Step 1 should be articulated using the analytical vocabulary of prior frames. Students select the 1–2 prior frames that most sharpen the tension being named. Total active frames: 2–3. W6 is the frame in which spiral selection quality is most visible and most assessable.

Weekend bridge: General ESO bank. Combo scaffold: Synthesis & Judgment (primary) + any two prior frames student selects. This is the first week students choose their own spiral combination. Example: "Should countries be required to contribute to a global climate fund?"

6. STUDENT PRE-RECORDING PROTOCOL

Share this protocol with students at the start of the track. It describes the student-facing procedure for every ESO Frames attempt.

- 1 Open the current week's Phrase Reference HTML.**
Locate it in the ESO/Frames section of the platform under the current week's folder.
- 2 Read the ESO question carefully.**
Do not begin planning until you have read the full question and understood what position or analysis it requires.
- 3 Work through the three-step frame process mentally.**
Use the Frames Argument Builder sequence for this week. Identify your answer to each step. Do not write your response out.
- 4 Identify your spiral frames (Week 2+).**
Identify 1–2 prior frames most naturally activated by this question. Decide where they will appear — woven into the argument, not appended at the end. You are targeting 2–3 total active frames per response.
- 5 Record.**
Speak from your mental plan. If you lose your place, use the frame steps as recovery anchors — return to the step you were on and continue.

7. SCORING REFERENCE

ESO Frames responses are scored 1–4. The platform score is holistic. For debrief purposes, orient discussion around the following descriptors.

Score	What It Reflects
4 / 4	All three frame steps clearly present and developed; middle step analytical and explicit; spiral frames integrated organically (W2+); argument coherent and well-supported
3 / 4	Frame structure present; middle step present but may be underdeveloped; spiral frames present but may feel appended rather than integrated; language adequate
2 / 4	Frame partially applied; middle step thin or missing; spiral absent or nominal; argument incomplete or loses coherence
1 / 4	Frame not identifiable in response; argument absent or significantly distorted; language significantly limits communication

INSTRUCTOR NOTE

Do not share score descriptors directly with students as a rubric. Use them to guide your selection of exemplar responses and to frame debrief discussion. Scaffold feedback on the platform is diagnostic — the score is always holistic.

8. ADMINISTRATIVE NOTES

- **Dashboard access:** b10-practice-platform.web.app — log in with your assigned B10-PP instructor ID.
- **Submission window:** Student audio is retained for 72 hours. Plan debriefs within this window.
- **Non-submitting students:** Follow up privately. Do not delay the class debrief.
- **8-question limit per weekly folder:** Each weekly ESO folder contains 8 questions. The pacing in this SOP distributes questions across the week without exhausting the folder. The weekend bridge always draws from the general ESO bank.
- **Score visibility:** Students see scores immediately after submission. Your debrief adds interpretive value — it does not gate scores.
- **Cycle reset:** After Week 6, the cycle repeats from Week 1. Students entering the second cycle carry full spiral knowledge — all six frames are active from Day 1 of the repeat cycle.

Linguistic Flexibility Practice — SLT Instructor Protocol

Role: SLT Instructor | Track: Linguistic Flexibility | Version 1.0 | Effective: July 27, 2026

1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This SOP governs the Linguistic Flexibility (LF) practice cycle for SLT instructors using the B10 Practice Platform (B10-PP). It applies to pull-out sessions with individual students or very small groups working toward ILR 2+/3 oral English proficiency.

The LF track addresses the sub-sentential and syntactic features that distinguish ILR 2+ production from ILR 3 production: control of word forms across derivational families, syntactic variety, the ability to combine ideas into well-connected arguments, and stance and perspective marking. These features are frequently the limiting factor in students who demonstrate adequate content knowledge in ESO practice but cannot yet sustain ILR 3 register across a full response.

The LF track is organized around **four subcategories**, each targeting a distinct linguistic skill. Practice is structured as a **skill cycle** — the SLT instructor introduces one subcategory per cycle, assigns independent practice between sessions, and evaluates mastery before moving to the next. Depth of practice within each subcategory takes priority over coverage of all four.

LF QUESTIONS — PRE-PILOT STATUS

The 32 LF practice questions (8 per subcategory) have been identified, sequenced, approved, and are available in the four LF subcategory folders in the Linguistic Flexibility section of the platform.

2. THE FOUR LF SUBCATEGORIES

The four subcategories are presented in the recommended default sequence. This sequence follows a bottom-up linguistic complexity progression — each subcategory builds on the skills developed in the previous one. SLT instructors may enter at any point based on diagnostic observation, but should document skipped subcategories for targeting in subsequent cycles.

Order	Subcategory	Tag	Core Skill	Prerequisite
1	Word Form Flexibility	WFF	Morphological control — derivational families, nominalization, adjectival and verbal forms	None — recommended starting point

2	Structural Variation	SV	Syntactic reordering — clause fronting, embedding, coordination, avoiding repetitive structure	Word Form Flexibility
3	Sentence Combining	SC	Idea integration — combining arguments into complex, cohesive utterances	Structural Variation
4	Perspective Integration	PI	Register and stance — embedding multiple viewpoints, signaling stance lexically and syntactically	Sentence Combining

ON THE SEQUENCE

Word Form Flexibility is the recommended starting point for all students new to the LF track, regardless of apparent proficiency level. Errors at the word form level are frequently masked in fluent speakers and only become visible under the production demands of ILR 3 ESO tasks. Beginning here ensures the foundation is solid before syntactic and discourse-level demands are introduced.

DIAGNOSTIC OVERRIDE

If scaffold feedback from a student's ESO/Frames attempts on the instructor dashboard consistently flags a specific LF subcategory as the limiting factor — or if instructor observation identifies a clear gap — the SLT instructor may enter the sequence at that subcategory. Document the entry point and note skipped subcategories as targets for the next cycle.

3. THE SKILL CYCLE

Each LF subcategory is practiced through a two-phase skill cycle. The cycle length is determined by student mastery, not by a fixed number of sessions.

Phase	When	What Happens	Go to Section
Phase 1 — Introduction Session	First session on a new LF subcategory	Introduce the subcategory; in-session attempt(s); immediate debrief; assign between-session practice	Section 4.1
Phase 2 — Follow-up Session(s)	Subsequent sessions on the same subcategory	Debrief between-session attempts; mastery check; assign remaining questions or advance	Section 4.2

SESSION FREQUENCY AND PACING

SLT sessions typically occur once or twice per week. Between-session practice (3–5 questions assigned after Phase 1) provides the primary volume of independent production. The instructor's role in Phase 2 is evaluation and direction, not re-instruction. If a student requires re-instruction on the same subcategory, that is a signal to slow the pacing, not to skip ahead.

4. SESSION PROCEDURES

4.1 — Phase 1: Introduction Session

You are beginning a session on a new LF subcategory. The student has not yet practiced this skill on the platform. Proceed in the following order.

1 Identify the target subcategory.

Select the LF subcategory for this cycle based on the default sequence (Section 2) or diagnostic observation. If this is the student's first session on the LF track, begin with Word Form Flexibility unless a specific gap has been identified.

2 Open the subcategory's reference HTML together.

Navigate to the Linguistic Flexibility section of the platform at b10-practice-platform.web.app/b10_practice_platform/. Open the reference HTML for the target subcategory. Read through it with the student — do not lecture from it. The reference is the instructional material; your role is to orient the student to how it works and what it is asking them to do.

3 Model the skill with one question in-session.

Select the first question from the subcategory's question bank. Walk through the task with the student before they record: identify the specific LF demand in the question, apply the reference HTML's guidance to plan a response, then have the student record. Do not record yourself — the model is the planning process, not the response.

4 Debrief the in-session attempt immediately.

After the student records, review the transcript together on the platform. Focus the debrief on the specific LF skill targeted by this subcategory. WFF: Did the student deploy varied word forms from the same derivational family? Where did they default to a single form? SV: Did sentence structure vary? Were there opportunities for fronting or embedding the student did not take? SC: Were ideas combined into connected utterances, or did the student produce a series of short, unconnected sentences? PI: Did the student signal stance and perspective explicitly? Were multiple viewpoints embedded within the same utterance or presented sequentially?

5 Assign between-session practice (3–5 questions).

Assign 3–5 questions from the current subcategory's question bank for the student to complete independently before the next session. For once-weekly sessions, 4–5 questions is appropriate. For twice-weekly, 3 questions is sufficient. Remind the student to use the reference HTML while practicing — the goal at this stage is accurate application of the skill, not speed or independence.

6 Set expectations for the next session.

Inform the student that the next session will begin by reviewing their between-session attempts. They should be prepared to discuss what they found easy or difficult about applying the skill independently.

4.2 — Phase 2: Follow-up Session(s)

You are beginning a session on a subcategory the student has already been introduced to. They have completed between-session practice attempts. Proceed in the following order.

1 Review between-session attempts via the instructor dashboard.

Before the session begins, open the instructor dashboard and locate the student's recent submissions in the LF subcategory folder. Note the scores and review one or two transcripts. Identify a strong attempt and an attempt with a visible gap — you will use both in the debrief.

2 Open the debrief with the strong attempt.

Play the audio of the strongest between-session attempt. Review the transcript with the student. Identify specifically what the student did well — name the LF feature and where in the response it appears. This calibrates the student to the target standard before gaps are discussed.

3 Debrief a gap attempt.

Play the audio of an attempt with a visible LF gap. Review the transcript. Use the subcategory-specific debrief questions from Phase 1, Step 4. Ask the student to identify the gap before naming it yourself — productive self-diagnosis is the target skill at this stage.

4

Conduct the mastery check.

Based on the between-session attempts and the in-session debrief, evaluate whether the student has demonstrated sufficient command of this LF subcategory to advance.

MASTERY STANDARD

The student consistently demonstrates the target LF skill across multiple attempts without instructor prompting. Errors are occasional, not systematic. The skill is visible in the response without the student having to stop and apply it consciously.

✓ MASTERY MET — ADVANCE

Move to the next LF subcategory in the sequence. Begin a new Phase 1 Introduction Session at the next meeting. Note the completed subcategory in your session records.

→ MASTERY NOT YET MET — CONTINUE

Assign the remaining questions from the current subcategory's bank (up to the 8-question limit). Schedule another follow-up session. If the student has exhausted all 8 questions without meeting the mastery standard, conduct an additional in-session attempt and discuss the specific persistent gap before reassigning selected questions for a second pass.

5

Assign next between-session practice.

If continuing in the same subcategory: assign 2–3 remaining questions from the bank. If advancing: inform the student which subcategory is next and direct them to preview the reference HTML before the next session.

5. LF SUBCATEGORY REFERENCE

Each entry below provides a skill description, ILR 3 rationale, debrief focus, and the question bank for that subcategory.

Word Form Flexibility

WFF

Skill description: The student varies word forms across a derivational family — moving fluidly between nominal, adjectival, verbal, and adverbial forms of the same root — to achieve precision, cohesion, and register appropriate to ILR 3 academic/policy discourse.

ILR 3 rationale: ILR 3 production requires sustained use of abstract, precise vocabulary. Students locked into a single word form produce output that reads as ILR 2+ in register even when the content is adequate. Word form control is the most discrete and teachable LF skill — errors are visible and correction is concrete.

DEBRIEF FOCUS

Did the student deploy varied word forms from the same derivational family? Where did they default to a single form? Where would a nominalization, adjectival form, or alternate verb form have increased precision or register?

Question bank (8 questions):

EDU-013 GOV-019 TEC-009 ENV-006 HLT-029 ECN-003 JUS-016 SOC-003

Suggested Phase 1 in-session question: EDU-013. Suggested between-session assignment: GOV-019, TEC-009, ENV-006, HLT-029 (4 for once-weekly; 3 for twice-weekly).

Structural Variation

SV

Skill description: The student varies clause and sentence structure across a response — using fronting, subordination, embedding, and coordination to avoid syntactic repetition and to foreground information rhetorically.

ILR 3 rationale: Repetitive subject-verb-object structure signals ILR 2+ even when vocabulary is strong. ILR 3 production requires syntactic flexibility — the ability to reorder, subordinate, and embed in ways that serve the argument. Structural variation is the syntactic counterpart to word form control.

DEBRIEF FOCUS

Did sentence structure vary across the response? Were there opportunities for fronting, embedding, or subordination that the student did not take? Where did repetitive structure flatten the argument or reduce register?

Question bank (8 questions):

HLT-002 ECN-019 GOV-020 INT-010 TEC-005 ENV-004 JUS-006 CUL-004

Suggested Phase 1 in-session question: HLT-002. Suggested between-session assignment: ECN-019, GOV-020, INT-010, TEC-005.

Sentence Combining

SC

Skill description: The student combines multiple ideas into complex, cohesive utterances — using relative clauses, participial phrases, apposition, and logical connectors to connect ideas that would otherwise appear as a series of short, disconnected sentences.

ILR 3 rationale: A connected, well-organized argument is a defining feature of ILR 3 production. A response of well-formed but unconnected sentences reads as ILR 2+ — the ideas are present but the reasoning does not hang together. Sentence combining is the productive skill that makes idea integration visible in spoken output. It requires both word form control and structural flexibility, which is why it follows those subcategories in the default sequence.

DEBRIEF FOCUS

Were ideas combined into complex utterances, or did the student produce a series of short, unconnected sentences?

Where could two or three ideas have been connected into one statement? Where does the lack of combining weaken the argument's flow and coherence?

Question bank (8 questions):

WRK-001 ENV-021 HLT-030 ECN-015 GOV-017 INT-015 TEC-021 CUL-009

Suggested Phase 1 in-session question: WRK-001. Suggested between-session assignment: ENV-021, HLT-030, ECN-015, GOV-017.

Perspective Integration

PI

Skill description: The student embeds multiple viewpoints within a single utterance — using reported speech frames, concessive structures, epistemic markers, and stance adverbials to signal whose perspective is being represented and how the speaker positions themselves relative to it.

ILR 3 rationale: ILR 3 ESO production requires the speaker to manage multiple perspectives simultaneously — presenting a position, acknowledging counterarguments, and signaling their own stance within a coherent argument. Students who can only present viewpoints sequentially are operating at ILR 2+. Perspective integration is the capstone LF skill — it presupposes all three prior subcategories.

DEBRIEF FOCUS

Did the student signal stance and perspective explicitly? Were multiple viewpoints embedded within the same utterance, or presented sequentially? Where did the student miss an opportunity to use a concessive structure, epistemic marker, or reported speech frame to integrate perspective?

Question bank (8 questions):

EDU-008 HLT-003 SOC-002 JUS-013 ECN-002 ENV-020 CUL-003 GOV-016

Suggested Phase 1 in-session question: EDU-008. Suggested between-session assignment: HLT-003, SOC-002, JUS-013, ECN-002.

6. CYCLE RESET AND RE-ENTRY

After a student completes all four subcategories, the cycle resets. Re-entry follows the same default sequence (WFF → SV → SC → PI), but the demand level increases: the student is now expected to deploy each LF skill with greater fluency, less reliance on the reference HTML, and greater integration across subcategories within a single response.

RE-ENTRY STANDARD

On a second pass through a subcategory, the mastery standard is higher: the reference HTML should function as confirmation, not initiation. A student who still requires the reference HTML to produce the target LF feature has not fully proceduralized the skill from the first cycle. Note this and adjust pacing — more in-session practice, fewer between-session questions assigned at once.

LF SCORING RUBRICS — IN DEVELOPMENT

Scoring rubrics for each LF subcategory are in development and will be integrated into the platform scaffold feedback system prior to full pilot expansion. Once deployed, scaffold feedback for LF attempts will function identically to discourse frame scaffold feedback — diagnostic and subcategory-specific, with the score remaining holistic. Until rubrics are deployed, SLT instructors should use the debrief focus questions in Section 5 as the primary evaluative framework.

7. RELATIONSHIP TO THE ESO/FRAMES TRACK

The LF track is a support track, not a parallel track. Its purpose is to develop the sub-sentential and syntactic skills that allow a student to execute discourse frame structures at ILR 3 register. Students who are struggling to achieve ILR 3 scores on ESO/Frames attempts despite adequate content knowledge are the primary referral population for SLT pull-out sessions.

- **Referral source:** Main Instructor observation, scaffold feedback patterns on the instructor dashboard, or student self-report of difficulty with specific LF features.
- **Coordination:** SLT instructors should communicate mastery progress to the Main Instructor so that LF gains can be reinforced in ESO/Frames practice. A student who has completed WFF should be expected to demonstrate improved word form control in their next ESO attempt.
- **Dashboard access:** SLT instructors use the same instructor dashboard at b10-practice-platform.web.app/b10_practice_platform/ to view student submissions, scores, transcripts, and scaffold feedback across all tracks — not only LF attempts.

8. ADMINISTRATIVE NOTES

- **Session length:** Pull-out sessions are typically 30–50 minutes. Phase 1 Introduction Sessions require the full session. Phase 2 Follow-up Sessions may be shorter depending on the number of between-session attempts to debrief.
- **Student credentials:** Students log in with their B10-PP ID and password. If a student cannot log in, contact the Main Instructor — passwords cannot be reset and re-enrollment requires the student's B10-PP ID.
- **Submission window:** Student audio is retained for 72 hours. Review between-session attempts before this window closes.
- **Session records:** Maintain a brief record of which LF subcategory each student is working on, their current phase, and the number of questions completed. This is especially important for students who see multiple SLT instructors across a course.
- **Question bank limit:** Each subcategory contains 8 questions. If a student exhausts the bank without meeting the mastery standard, conduct an additional in-session attempt using a question from the general ESO bank and apply the same LF debrief focus.

- **LF reference HTMLs:** Available in the Linguistic Flexibility section of the platform. Each HTML is subcategory-specific and contains skill guidance, examples, and phrase-level support. Students may use these as a reference during between-session practice.

Memory Training Strategies

Instructor Reference — Five Listening and Retention Strategies for CORE Bundle Practice

Each night, students complete a CORE Bundle assignment — two listening passages and one extended speaking question. The CORE listening task requires them to retain and immediately paraphrase a 70--85 word ILR 3 passage after a single listen, with no notes. These five Memory Training Strategies give students different tools for that task. Each addresses a distinct retention challenge. Instructors designate one strategy per nightly assignment and debrief its effectiveness the following morning. Students select the strategy that best fits how they process information under the demands of this specific task.

MTS 1 · Keyword Anchoring

Remember: Works best when the passage has clear content nouns -- specific topics, places, groups, or processes. If anchors are not pulling back enough detail, try *Chunking + Immediate Rehearsal* or *Gist-First*.

MTS 2 · Chunking + Immediate Rehearsal

Remember: Works best for passages that present several distinct ideas in sequence. If chunks collapse into each other, try *Gist-First / Details-Second*, which separates the main idea from details rather than trying to hold both at once.

MTS 3 · Gist-First / Details-Second

Remember: Works best when the passage has one clear central argument or finding. If the passage covers several equally weighted ideas, try *Chunking + Immediate Rehearsal*, which treats each idea as its own unit.

MTS 4 · Idea Skeleton

Remember: Works best for dense, complex sentences with heavy academic or policy language. If the passage is more narrative, try *Chunking + Immediate Rehearsal*. If skeletons lose logical connections between ideas, try *Gist-First*.

MTS 5 · Response Template

Remember: Works best for students who lose time and fluency figuring out how to begin speaking. If starting is not your problem -- if you lose content rather than structure -- try *Keyword Anchoring* or *Chunking + Immediate Rehearsal* instead. For many students, combining Response Template with one other strategy produces the strongest results.

Keyword Anchoring

Pick 2--3 words while you listen. Use them to pull back everything else.

What this strategy does: Instead of trying to remember everything at once, you identify 2--3 content-rich words during listening and use them as anchors to retrieve the full meaning when you record.

1

Before
Listening

Get ready to catch words, not sentences.

Tell yourself: "I am not going to remember everything. I am going to pick the 2--3 most important words and hold onto those." This is a deliberate shift -- most people try to memorize the whole passage and lose it. You are going to anchor instead.

2

While Listening

Identify the 2--3 words that carry the most meaning.

Listen for content-dense words -- nouns, verbs, or specific terms the whole passage seems to be about. You do not need to remember everything around them yet -- just lock those words in.

3

Right After

Say your anchor words silently -- once.

The moment the passage ends, confirm your 2--3 anchor words. If one is fuzzy, replace it now with a word you remember more clearly. Do not try to recall the whole passage yet.

4

Before
Recording

Use each anchor word to pull back what surrounds it.

Take your first anchor and ask: "What was happening around this word in the passage?" Let details come back through the anchor, not independently. Do the same for each anchor. You now have the structure of your response.

5

Recording

Speak through your anchors in order.

Start with the most central anchor word and build your response from there. If you lose your place, return to the next anchor and continue.

Watch out for this

Avoid anchors that are too general -- words like policy, people, or problem will not pull back specific content. Your anchors need to be specific enough that the details come back with them.

Chunking + Immediate Rehearsal

Break the passage into pieces. Repeat each piece to yourself as it arrives.

What this strategy does: Instead of holding the whole passage in memory at once, you divide it into smaller idea chunks as you listen and silently repeat each chunk before the next one arrives.

1

Before
Listening

Decide to listen in pieces, not as a whole.

Tell yourself: "I am going to catch the first idea, repeat it to myself, then move to the next." Process as you go -- do not wait until the end. Your job is to find the natural breaks in the passage.

2

While Listening

Catch the first idea and hold it.

As soon as the first complete idea arrives, compress it into a short phrase and repeat it silently. Keep that phrase active while you continue listening. Do not write anything down.

3

While Listening

Layer in each new idea as it arrives.

When the next idea begins, compress it the same way and add it to what you are already holding. Build a short stack of compressed phrases -- not full sentences -- stacked together.

4

Right After

Run through your stack once -- in order.

The moment the passage ends, silently run through your chunks from first to last. This rehearsal pass locks in the sequence. Replace any unclear chunk with whatever you do remember.

5

Recording

Speak through your chunks in order.

Use your stack as the structure of your response. Expand each compressed phrase into a full sentence as you speak -- the chunk is the skeleton, your words are the flesh.

Watch out for this

Keep chunks short -- 4 to 6 words maximum. If chunk phrases run to full sentences, you will not be able to hold them while listening continues.

Gist-First / Details-Second

Catch the main point on the first pass. Let the details come back from it.

What this strategy does: You separate your listening into two goals -- first pass is main idea only, second pass is details. This reduces cognitive overload by giving your memory one job at a time.

1

Before
Listening

Decide your only job on the first pass is the main point.

Tell yourself: "I am not going to try to catch the details yet. I am going to ask one question: what is this passage mainly about?" Let the details wash over you -- your brain will hold more than you think if you are not fighting to hold everything at once.

2

While Listening

Listen for the one-sentence answer to "What is this mainly about?"

Do not try to catch specific facts or supporting points. Follow the overall direction -- what is it arguing, reporting, or describing? By the end, complete this sentence: "This passage is mainly about ____."

3

Right After
First Pass

Lock in your gist sentence -- then ask what supports it.

Say your gist sentence to yourself once. Then ask: "What did the passage say to support or explain this?" Details come back more easily now that the main idea is anchored. Pull back 2--3 supporting points.

4

Before
Recording

Build your response structure: main point first, details after.

Plan your response in the same order as your memory process: gist first, then supporting details. This is also the correct response structure for this task -- main idea first, details second, every time.

5

Recording

State the main point, then develop with recovered details.

Open with your gist sentence -- stated clearly and directly. Then move through supporting details. If a detail is fuzzy, state what you remember and move on. The gist is always your anchor if you lose your place.

Watch out for this

Do not start your response with a detail instead of the main point. Many students begin with the first thing they remember -- which is often a specific fact, not the main idea. Always lead with the gist.

Idea Skeleton

Strip each sentence to its core. Restore the detail when you speak.

What this strategy does: While listening, you mentally compress each sentence down to its bare bones -- who does what -- and discard the surrounding language. When you record, you rebuild the full meaning from the skeleton.

1

Before
Listening

Prepare to strip sentences as they arrive.

Tell yourself: "For every sentence I hear, I am going to find the core: who or what is doing something, and what are they doing?" Hedges, qualifiers, and descriptive phrases come back later -- right now you are only keeping the skeleton.

2

While Listening

For each sentence, find: Who? Does what? To what effect?

Mentally extract three things: the subject, the action, and the result or direction. Drop everything else -- tense markers, adjectives, adverbs, hedges. You are left with the skeleton of the idea.

WHO

developing nations

WHAT

face electricity access gaps

WHERE

rural communities -- despite investment

3

While Listening

Stack your skeletons as the passage continues.

Hold your first skeleton while you strip the next sentence. Build a short stack of compressed ideas -- not full sentences, just the core of each. Three or four skeletons is a strong foundation for a 70--85 word passage.

4

Right After

Run through your skeletons and begin restoring detail.

Say your skeletons to yourself in order. For each one, ask: "What do I remember about how this was described or qualified?" Add back whatever detail returns. The skeleton gives you something to say even if detail is thin.

5

Recording

Rebuild each skeleton into a full sentence as you speak.

Use each skeleton as the frame for a spoken sentence. Build a complete, natural sentence around the who, what, and direction you held in memory. Your response will be more precise than if you had tried to hold full sentences.

Watch out for this

"Despite investment --> still gap" is better than "investment · gap" -- keep the logic of the sentence, not just the nouns and verbs. The skeleton should preserve cause, contrast, and sequence.

Response Template

Know exactly how you will begin speaking before you listen.

What this strategy does: You memorize a fixed opening structure before you listen -- so when it is time to record, you already know how your response will begin. This frees your memory to focus entirely on content, not on how to start speaking.

1

Before
Listening

Memorize the template -- you will use it every time.

The Response Template is a fixed three-part structure. You do not change it from passage to passage -- you fill it in with different content each time.

Response Template

Part 1 -- Main point: "The main point of this passage is that *[main idea]*."

Part 2 -- First detail: "The passage also states that *[detail 1]*."

Part 3 -- Second detail: "Additionally, *[detail 2]*."

2

While Listening

Listen to fill in the three slots -- not to memorize everything.

Your only job while listening is to find three things: the main point, and two supporting details. You already know how you will say them -- the template handles that. Focus entirely on the what, not the how.

3

Right After

Fill in your three slots.

Say to yourself: "Main point: _____. Detail 1: _____. Detail 2: _____." Keep each slot short -- a phrase, not a full sentence. If you remember a third detail, hold it as a bonus -- but do not let searching for it crowd out the first two.

4

Recording

Speak the template -- slot by slot.

Begin recording and go straight into Part 1: "The main point of this passage is that..." Fill in your slot. Move to Part 2, then Part 3. Add a bonus detail naturally after Part 3 if you have one.

Watch out for this

Use the template until starting a response feels automatic -- then begin varying your opening language. The template is a training wheel, not a permanent structure.

Frames Practice — Argument Builder Reference

How to use this sheet: Before you record, identify your frame. Work through the three questions left to right — your response must address all three. A response that skips the middle question is incomplete. The middle column is where most responses fall short.

W1 Scale & Stakeholder

Stakeholder <i>Who is affected and at what level?</i>	Impact <i>What specifically happens to them?</i>	Scale Consideration <i>Why does operating at that level change the argument?</i>
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W2 Trade-offs & Constraints

Benefit <i>What does the policy achieve?</i>	Trade-off <i>What competing good is sacrificed?</i>	Constraint <i>Why can't the trade-off simply be avoided?</i>
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W3 Causal Systems

Trigger <i>What sets the causal chain in motion?</i>	Mechanism <i>How does the effect actually get produced?</i>	Downstream Effect <i>What results at the end of the chain?</i>
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W4 Hypothetical & Conditional

Condition <i>What condition must hold for this scenario to follow?</i>	Projected Outcome <i>What would likely result?</i>	Extended Scenario <i>And if that outcome holds, then what?</i>
--	--	--

W5 Values, Heuristics & Bias

Value <i>What does this stakeholder believe is important?</i>	Assumption <i>What must be true for that value to justify their position?</i>	Competing Framework <i>What does a stakeholder on the other side believe instead?</i>
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W6 Synthesis & Judgment

Tensions <i>What competing claims must be addressed?</i>	Priorities <i>Which consideration carries more weight and why?</i>	Judgment <i>What is the most defensible conclusion?</i>
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Remember: Naming a trade-off, a mechanism, a projected outcome, an assumption, or a priority — and explaining *why* — is what separates an ILR 2+ response from an ILR 3 one. Scaffold feedback is diagnostic only. Your score is always holistic.

Week 1 Enabling Activities

Scale & Stakeholder

This set covers the full six-activity family for Scale & Stakeholder, organized as two tracks: 1a--1c build the Stakeholder → Impact → Scale Consideration move in stages; 4a--4c test whether it has proceduralized. These supplement -- they do not replace -- this week's folder and the ESO/Frames Daily Protocol.

This Week's Frame — Scale & Stakeholder (W1)

Stakeholder

Who is affected, and at what level?

Impact

What specifically happens to them?

Scale Consideration

Why does operating at that level change the argument?

Key requirement: every response this week engages at least two scale levels — Individual & Family · Organizational & Community · National & Global. A response that stays at one scale level does not meet the standard for this frame.

Activity Index

1a. Single-Scenario Depth Ladder · 1b. Sentence-Frame Progression · 1c. 3-Interval Comparison & Paraphrase · 4a. 2-Box Induction · 4b. Silent Protocol & Brief-Back · 4c. Strategic Competence & Fallback

Single-Scenario Depth Ladder — "Scaffold the Scaffold"

Holds one low-stakes scenario constant while building the Stakeholder → Impact → Scale Consideration move in four steps. Use before a student's first W1 attempt, or as remediation if two scale levels aren't yet showing up reliably.

ANCHOR SCENARIO (HELD CONSTANT ACROSS ALL FOUR ITEMS)

A city runs a neighborhood recycling program.

1

Surface

"Who is affected by the recycling program, and at what scale?"

Name one stakeholder and one scale level only.

2

Surface → Deep

"What specifically happens to [that stakeholder] at the individual level?"

Add the Impact box. Still one scale level.

3

Deep

"At the individual level, residents sort their own trash. At the organizational level, ____."

Complete the second scale level. Connector is half-supplied.

4

Transfer

"Should cities expand recycling programs to apartment buildings?"

Full response: stakeholder + impact + scale consideration, spanning two levels, no connector given.

Instructor note: 5--10 minute warm-up. A student who completes Item 4 without hesitation is ready for the Week 1 folder.

Causal Subordination → Concessive Subordination → Relative Clause & Appositive

Builds subordinate-clause complexity in three tiers using connectors that read as ILR 2+/3, not just connectors that are technically subordinating. Coordinating conjunctions (FANBOYS) are excluded -- and so are 'because' and 'so': both are grammatically fine, but they're exactly the safe, overused connectors that inflate a proficiency ceiling. T1 uses higher-register causal subordinators with more precision.

SCENARIO

A company is considering a shift to a four-day work week.

T1

Causal subordination — given that / on the grounds that / considering that

Complete each sentence, naming one stakeholder and one impact.

- "Employees support the four-day week given that ____."
- "The company is willing to try it on the grounds that ____."
- "Managers remain cautious considering that ____."

T2

Concessive subordination — although / while / even though

Hold two competing stakeholders or scale levels in tension inside one sentence.

- "While employees gain an extra day, managers ____."
- "Although individual workers benefit immediately, the organization ____."
- "Even though the policy helps employees short-term, the company ____."

T3a

Restrictive relative clauses — "Fact who ____, Fact"

Complete each sentence with a relative clause. Then combine them into one sentence using a subordinating conjunction of choice.

- "Employees who ____ report higher morale."
- "Managers who ____ face new coordination demands."

T3b

Appositives — "Fact, ____, Fact"

Compress the stakeholder's identity into a noun phrase and embed it as a non-restrictive appositive.

MODEL

"Employees, the primary beneficiaries at the individual level, report higher morale, while the organization, absorbing the shift at the institutional level, must redesign its scheduling systems."

Instructor note: 'because' and 'so' aren't FANBOYS, but they're the safe, overused connectors that flag a proficiency ceiling. T1 swaps them for 'given that' / 'on the grounds that' / 'considering that' -- same causal entry point, higher register from the first sentence. Move to T2 only once T1 is fluent. T3a is the entry point — relative clauses are the simpler move. T3b compresses a full clause into a noun phrase — more demanding. Move to T3b only once T1 is fluent. Both are stretch — optional for students still consolidating T1 and T2.

Comparison & Paraphrase Prompts

Connects stakeholder/scale vocabulary to comparative sentence structures, moving from a simple one-line comparison to a claim that explicitly spans two scale levels.

COMPARISON PAIR

How a new policy affects a single employee — and how it affects the company as a whole.

Target Lexicon — must appear at least once

stakeholder

disproportionate

aggregate

at the
[X]
level

on
balance

1

Surface

"In one sentence, compare how the childcare policy affects one employee versus the company overall."

2

Deep

"Using disproportionate, explain whether the individual-level and organizational-level impacts are the same size."

3

Transfer

"Write one complex sentence connecting the individual-level impact to the organizational-level impact, using aggregate or on balance."

Instructor note: score for lexicon use and the logical connector between levels — not for stance. A student may argue either direction as long as both levels are represented.

Visual Synthesis

Forces students to infer the scale-shift pattern themselves from grouped, unlabeled examples — no rule is stated up front.

Box A

- A parent saves \$400 a month on childcare.
- A commuter saves twenty minutes each way.
- One employee receives a signing bonus.

Box B

- The company reports 12% lower turnover.
- The city's traffic congestion drops 8%.
- The agency's total payroll costs rise \$2 million.

TASK

What is similar about the statements in Box A? What is similar about Box B? How are Box A and Box B related to each other? Answer using a contrastive subordinating conjunction — while, whereas, or even though.

Instructor note: don't pre-explain the boxes. Let the student name the pattern (individual/family-level vs. organizational/national-level) in their own words before you confirm it.

Silent Modeling & Pre-Attempt Brief-Back

Separates rule comprehension from production. Students extract the frame's structure from a marked-but-unexplained model, then must plan out loud before they're allowed to attempt their own response.

PHASE 1 — SILENT MODELING

Read the response below. Three elements are marked [A], [B], [C], [D]. No explanation is given — identify what each represents before moving to Phase 2.

[A] Working parents are affected at the individual and family level — [B] they save on childcare costs and face less scheduling stress. [C] But the policy also reaches employers at the organizational level, where the added cost of subsidized childcare must be absorbed into the budget. [D] Because the same policy produces a direct benefit for individuals but a structural cost for the organization, the two levels cannot be judged by the same standard — what looks purely positive individually introduces a real trade-off once the organization has to pay for it.

Key (reveal only after Phase 2). In the digital version, each move is color-highlighted. In print, use letter markers above.



[A] =
Stakeholder



[B] =
Impact



[C] =
Scale



[D] = Scale
Consideration

PHASE 2 — VERBAL BRIEF-BACK ("PLAN BEFORE YOU PRODUCE")

Before attempting your own response to the prompt below, say out loud -- or write in one sentence -- your plan for each of the frame's three moves. Do not begin your full response until you've stated your plan.

PROMPT FOR PHASE 2 ATTEMPT

"Should employers be required to give all workers four weeks of paid vacation?"

Instructor note: the brief-back is a planning checkpoint, not a rehearsal -- keep it to one sentence. This models a legitimate strategy: a brief pause to organize before speaking.

Fallback Scaffolding

Tests whether the frame's core move survives without its own vocabulary -- the ILR 3 skill of knowing what to do when the exact word isn't available.

CONSTRAINT

Restate the argument below without using the bolded words. Add hedging language as you restate.

Argument to Restate

Residents are the primary **stakeholders** at the individual **level** — the program directly **affects** how much household waste reaches landfills. Building managers are **stakeholders** at the organizational **level** — the expanded program **impacts** their operating budget and maintenance schedules.

PROMPT

"Should cities expand recycling programs to apartment buildings?"

Fallback Strategies to Practice

a

Circumlocution

Instead of "stakeholder," try "the people this touches" or "whoever has to deal with this."

b

Level substitution

Instead of "at the individual level," try "for one person living there" / "for the building's management."

c

Self-correction

"What I mean is..." / "Let me put that another way..."

d

Hedging

"It seems to change things for..." / "This tends to matter more for..."

Instructor note: use after a student is reliably producing the frame vocabulary. The argument frame provides the content — the task is circumlocution, hedging, not generation from scratch. This is a stress test, not a first attempt.

Week 2 Enabling Activities

Trade-offs & Constraints

This set covers the full six-activity family for Trade-offs & Constraints, organized as two tracks: 1a--1c build the Benefit → Trade-off → Constraint move in stages; 4a--4c test whether it has proceduralized. These supplement -- they do not replace -- this week's folder and the ESO/Frames Daily Protocol.

This Week's Frame — Trade-offs & Constraints (W2)

Benefit

What does the policy achieve?

Trade-off

What competing good is sacrificed?

Constraint

Why can't the trade-off simply be avoided?

Key requirement: the constraint step must show why the trade-off is structural — a response that names what's given up without explaining why it can't be preserved alongside the benefit does not meet the standard.

Activity Index

1a. Single-Scenario Depth Ladder · 1b. Sentence-Frame Progression · 1c. 3-Interval Comparison & Paraphrase · 4a. 2-Box Induction · 4b. Silent Protocol & Brief-Back · 4c. Strategic Competence & Fallback

Single-Scenario Depth Ladder — "Scaffold the Scaffold"

Holds one low-stakes scenario constant while building the Benefit → Trade-off → Constraint move in four steps. Use before a student's first W2 attempt, or as remediation if the constraint step isn't yet showing up as structural.

ANCHOR SCENARIO (HELD CONSTANT ACROSS ALL FOUR ITEMS)

A city converts a lane of street parking into a protected bike lane.

1

Surface

"What does converting the parking lane to a bike lane achieve?"

Name one benefit only.

2

Surface → Deep

"What is given up to get that benefit?"

Add the Trade-off box. Just name what's sacrificed — don't explain why yet.

3

Deep

"The city gains safer cycling routes. Local businesses lose customer parking, and ____."

Complete the Constraint — why the trade-off can't just be undone (the street width is fixed).

4

Transfer

"Should cities convert more downtown streets to bike lanes?"

Full response: benefit + trade-off + constraint, no connector given.

Instructor note: 5--10 minute warm-up. A student who completes Item 4 without hesitation is ready for the Week 2 folder.

Causal Subordination → Concessive Subordination → Relative Clause & Appositive

Builds subordinate-clause complexity in three tiers using connectors that read as ILR 2+/3, not just connectors that are technically subordinating. Coordinating conjunctions (FANBOYS) are excluded -- and so are 'because' and 'so': both are grammatically fine, but they're exactly the safe, overused connectors that inflate a proficiency ceiling. T1 uses higher-register causal subordinators with more precision.

SCENARIO

A city converts a lane of street parking into a protected bike lane.

T1

Causal subordination — given that / on the grounds that / considering that

Complete each sentence, naming one benefit.

- "Cyclists support the new bike lane given that ____."
- "The city council is willing to approve the conversion on the grounds that ____."
- "Nearby businesses remain open to the idea considering that ____."

T2

Concessive subordination — although / while / even though

Hold the benefit and the trade-off in tension inside one sentence.

- "While cyclists gain a safer route, local drivers ____."
- "Although the bike lane reduces accidents, nearby shop owners ____."
- "Even though the city gains a greener image, businesses along the route ____."

T3a

Restrictive relative clauses — "Fact who ____, Fact"

Complete each sentence with a relative clause. Then combine them into one sentence using a subordinating conjunction of choice.

- "Cyclists who ____ gain safer commuting routes."
- "Shop owners who ____ face reduced customer access."

T3b

Appositives — "Fact, ____, Fact"

Compress the stakeholder's identity into a noun phrase and embed it as a non-restrictive appositive.

MODEL

"Cyclists, the primary beneficiaries of the new protected lane, report feeling safer commuting, while local shop owners, facing a steep drop in curbside customers, argue the trade-off wasn't fairly weighed."

Instructor note: 'because' and 'so' aren't FANBOYS, but they're the safe, overused connectors that flag a proficiency ceiling. T1 swaps them for 'given that' / 'on the grounds that' / 'considering that' -- same causal entry point, higher register from the first sentence. Move to T2 only once T1 is fluent. T3a is the entry point — relative clauses are the simpler move. T3b compresses a full clause into a noun phrase — more demanding. Move to T3b only once T1 is fluent. Both are stretch — optional for students still consolidating T1 and T2.

Comparison & Paraphrase Prompts

Connects trade-off vocabulary to comparative sentence structures, moving from a simple one-line comparison to a claim that explicitly names the trade-off as structural.

COMPARISON PAIR

How the bike lane's benefit to cyclists compares with its cost to local businesses.

Target Lexicon — must appear at least once

trade-off

inherent

structural

at the
expense
of

on the
whole

1

Surface

"In one sentence, compare the benefit cyclists get from the new lane with the cost local businesses bear."

2

Deep

"Using structural, explain whether the cost to businesses is incidental or built into the design of the bike lane itself."

3

Transfer

"Write one complex sentence connecting the benefit to cyclists and the cost to businesses, using inherent or at the expense of."

Instructor note: score for lexicon use and whether the response correctly identifies the trade-off as structural — not for stance on whether the bike lane is worth it.

Visual Synthesis

Forces students to infer what makes a trade-off complete versus incomplete from grouped, unlabeled examples — no rule is stated up front.

Box A

- The company saved \$2M a year by switching to remote work.
- The city cut traffic accidents by installing more streetlights.
- The school raised test scores by extending the school day.

Box B

- The company saved \$2M a year by switching to remote work, but lost the spontaneous collaboration that used to happen in the office.
- The city cut traffic accidents by installing more streetlights, but raised its annual energy costs by 15%.
- The school raised test scores by extending the school day, but cut into students' time for after-school jobs and family responsibilities.

TASK

What is missing from the statements in Box A that Box B includes? Why is a Box B-style statement a stronger analytical claim? Answer using a concessive subordinating conjunction — although, while, or even though.

Instructor note: don't pre-explain the boxes. Box A statements aren't wrong, they're incomplete for this week's purposes. Let the student name what's missing before you confirm it.

Silent Modeling & Pre-Attempt Brief-Back

Separates rule comprehension from production. Students extract the frame's structure from a marked-but-unexplained model, then must plan out loud before they're allowed to attempt their own response.

PHASE 1 — SILENT MODELING

Read the response below. Three elements are marked [A], [B], [C]. No explanation is given — identify what each represents before moving to Phase 2.

[A] The city gains safer cycling routes and reduced traffic emissions along the corridor — a direct benefit for commuters who switch from driving to biking. **[B]** But that same redesign removes forty on-street parking spaces that local shop owners relied on for customer turnover. **[C]** Because the street's width is fixed, there's no way to add the bike lane without removing an equivalent amount of parking somewhere on that block — the trade-off isn't a side effect of poor planning, it's the only way the two uses can physically coexist on the same strip of pavement.

Key (reveal only after Phase 2). In the digital version, each move is color-highlighted. In print, use letter markers above.



[A] = Benefit



[B] =
Trade-off



[C] =
Constraint

PHASE 2 — VERBAL BRIEF-BACK ("PLAN BEFORE YOU PRODUCE")

Before attempting your own response to the prompt below, say out loud -- or write in one sentence -- your plan for each of the frame's three moves. Do not begin your full response until you've stated your plan.

PROMPT FOR PHASE 2 ATTEMPT

"Should cities make new bike lanes permanent after a trial period, or restore the parking once testing ends?"

Instructor note: the brief-back is a planning checkpoint, not a rehearsal -- keep it to one sentence. This models a legitimate strategy: a brief pause to organize before speaking.

Fallback Scaffolding

Tests whether the frame's core move survives without its own vocabulary -- the ILR 3 skill of knowing what to do when the exact word isn't available.

CONSTRAINT

Restate the argument below without using the bolded words. Add hedging language as you restate.

Argument to Restate

The bike lane delivers a clear **benefit** to cyclists — safer, faster commuting along the corridor. But it comes with a **trade-off**: forty parking spaces that local shops depended on are removed. This is a structural **constraint** — the street's width is fixed, so adding the lane and keeping the parking are physically incompatible.

PROMPT

"Should cities convert more downtown streets to bike lanes?"

Fallback Strategies to Practice

a

Circumlocution

Instead of "trade-off," try "what has to give" or "the thing you lose to get this."

b

Term substitution

Instead of "benefit" / "constraint," try "what's gained" / "the reason it can't be avoided."

c

Self-correction

"What I mean is..." / "Let me put that another way..."

d

Hedging

"It seems to come with a cost..." / "This tends to require giving something up..."

Instructor note: use after a student is reliably producing the frame vocabulary. The argument frame provides the content — the task is circumlocution, not hedging, not generation from scratch. This is a stress test, not a first attempt.

Week 3 Enabling Activities

Causal Systems

This set covers the full six-activity family for Causal Systems, organized as two tracks: 1a--1c build the Trigger → Mechanism → Downstream Effect move in stages; 4a--4c test whether it has proceduralized. These supplement -- they do not replace -- this week's folder and the ESO/Frames Daily Protocol.

This Week's Frame — Causal Systems (W3)

Trigger

What sets the causal chain in motion?

Mechanism

How does the effect actually get produced?

Downstream Effect

What results at the end of the chain?

Key requirement: the mechanism step must be explicit. A response that names the trigger and the downstream effect but skips how one produces the other is operating at ILR 2+, not ILR 3.

Activity Index

1a. Single-Scenario Depth Ladder · 1b. Sentence-Frame Progression · 1c. 3-Interval Comparison & Paraphrase · 4a. 2-Box Induction · 4b. Silent Protocol & Brief-Back · 4c. Strategic Competence & Fallback

Single-Scenario Depth Ladder — "Scaffold the Scaffold"

Holds one low-stakes scenario constant while building the Trigger → Mechanism → Downstream Effect move in four steps. Use before a student's first W3 attempt, or as remediation if the mechanism step isn't yet explicit.

ANCHOR SCENARIO (HELD CONSTANT ACROSS ALL FOUR ITEMS)

A city introduces a tax on sugary drinks.

1

Surface

"What triggers a change in behavior when the city introduces the tax?"

Name one trigger only.

2

Surface → Deep

"What is the downstream effect, in the end?"

Add the Downstream Effect box. Trigger and effect only — don't explain how they connect yet.

3

Deep

"The tax raises the price of sugary drinks. This leads many consumers to ____, which over time reduces population-level sugary consumption."

Complete the Mechanism — the missing middle step connecting trigger to effect.

4

Transfer

"Should cities also tax sugary snacks, not just drinks?"

Full response: trigger + mechanism + downstream effect, no connector given.

Instructor note: 5--10 minute warm-up. A student who completes Item 4 without hesitation is ready for the Week 3 folder.

Causal Subordination → Concessive Subordination → Relative Clause & Appositive

Builds subordinate-clause complexity in three tiers using connectors that read as ILR 2+/3, not just connectors that are technically subordinating. Coordinating conjunctions (FANBOYS) are excluded -- and so are 'because' and 'so': both are grammatically fine, but they're exactly the safe, overused connectors that inflate a proficiency ceiling. T1 uses higher-register causal subordinators with more precision.

SCENARIO

A city introduces a tax on sugary drinks.

T1

Causal subordination — given that / on the grounds that / considering that

Complete each sentence, naming one trigger.

- "Consumers switch to water and diet drinks given that ____."
- "Retailers stock more low-sugar alternatives on the grounds that ____."
- "Health officials expect the policy to work considering that ____."

T2

Concessive subordination — although / while / even though

Hold the immediate reaction and the downstream effect in tension inside one sentence.

- "While the tax raises prices immediately, the real health impact ____."
- "Although sales of sugary drinks drop right away, population-level health outcomes ____."
- "Even though the trigger is simple — a price increase — the mechanism that produces the effect ____."

T3a

Restrictive relative clauses — "Fact who ____, Fact"

Complete each sentence with a relative clause. Then combine them into one sentence using a subordinating conjunction of choice.

- "Consumers who ____ shift toward cheaper, lower-sugar alternatives."
- "Health officials who ____ predict measurable reductions in population-level sugar intake."

T3b

Appositives — "Fact, ____, Fact"

Compress the stakeholder's identity into a noun phrase and embed it as a non-restrictive appositive.

MODEL

"The price increase, the immediate trigger for changed shopping habits, pushes many households toward cheaper alternatives while the resulting drop in sugar consumption, compounding gradually across the population, only shows up in health statistics later."

Instructor note: 'because' and 'so' aren't FANBOYS, but they're the safe, overused connectors that flag a proficiency ceiling. T1 swaps them for 'given that' / 'on the grounds that' / 'considering that' -- same causal entry point, higher register from the first sentence. Move to T2 only once T1 is fluent. T3a is the entry point — relative clauses are the simpler move. T3b compresses a full clause into a noun phrase — more demanding. Move to T3b only once T1 is fluent. Both are stretch — optional for students still consolidating T1 and T2.

Comparison & Paraphrase Prompts

Connects causal-chain vocabulary to comparative sentence structures, moving from a simple one-line comparison to a claim that explicitly traces trigger to downstream effect.

COMPARISON PAIR

How the tax's immediate effect on drink sales compares with its downstream effect on public health.

Target Lexicon — must appear at least once

mechanism

triggers

in turn

downstream

as a
direct
result

1

Surface

"In one sentence, compare the tax's immediate effect on drink sales with its downstream effect on public health."

2

Deep

"Using mechanism, explain what specifically has to happen between the price increase and any change in health outcomes."

3

Transfer

"Write one complex sentence connecting the trigger to the downstream effect, using in turn or as a direct result."

Instructor note: score for lexicon use and whether the mechanism step is traceable step by step — not for whether the tax is good policy.

Visual Synthesis

Forces students to infer the difference between a direct cause and a systemic, feedback-loop cause from grouped, unlabeled examples — no rule is stated up front.

Box A

- A bridge collapses because a support beam fractures under weight.
- A company's profits drop because a major client cancels their contract.
- A crop fails because a drought destroys the plants directly.

Box B

- A bridge collapses because decades of deferred maintenance funding created a slow-building weakness that a routine load finally exposed.
- A company's profits drop because a competitor's price cut triggers a price war that erodes margins across the industry, including the company's other product lines.
- A crop fails because reduced snowpack years earlier lowered the water table, so a mild dry spell leaves no groundwater reserve to fall back on.

TASK

Both boxes explain a collapse, a profit drop, and a crop failure. What is different about how Box A and Box B explain their outcomes? Why is a Box B-style explanation a stronger causal analysis at ILR 3?

Instructor note: Box A collapses trigger straight into effect; Box B traces a mechanism with steps and time delay. Let the student name that difference before you confirm it.

Silent Modeling & Pre-Attempt Brief-Back

Separates rule comprehension from production. Students extract the frame's structure from a marked-but-unexplained model, then must plan out loud before they're allowed to attempt their own response.

PHASE 1 — SILENT MODELING

Read the response below. Three elements are marked [A], [B], [C]. No explanation is given — identify what each represents before moving to Phase 2.

[A] The city's new tax raises the price of sugary drinks at checkout — an immediate change shoppers notice right away. **[B]** Faced with the higher price, many switch to water, diet alternatives, or smaller portions — a shift that spreads through the population as the price difference becomes routine rather than novel. **[C]** Over several years, average per-capita sugar intake from beverages falls measurably, with the reduction showing up first in dental health records, long before it appears in broader obesity statistics.

Key (reveal only after Phase 2). In the digital version, each move is color-highlighted. In print, use letter markers above.



[A] = Trigger



[B] =
Mechanism



[C] =
Downstream
Effect

PHASE 2 — VERBAL BRIEF-BACK ("PLAN BEFORE YOU PRODUCE")

Before attempting your own response to the prompt below, say out loud -- or write in one sentence -- your plan for each of the frame's three moves. Do not begin your full response until you've stated your plan.

PROMPT FOR PHASE 2 ATTEMPT

"Should the tax rate increase every year to keep pace with inflation, or stay fixed at its introductory level?"

Instructor note: the brief-back is a planning checkpoint, not a rehearsal -- keep it to one sentence. This models a legitimate strategy: a brief pause to organize before speaking.

Fallback Scaffolding

Tests whether the frame's core move survives without its own vocabulary -- the ILR 3 skill of knowing what to do when the exact word isn't available.

CONSTRAINT

Restate the argument below without using the bolded words. Add hedging language as you restate.

Argument to Restate

The price increase is the **trigger** — shoppers notice it immediately at checkout. The **mechanism** is behavioral: faced with higher costs, many switch to water or diet alternatives, and that shift compounds across the population over time. The **downstream effect** is a measurable reduction in sugar consumption, showing up first in dental records before appearing in broader health statistics.

PROMPT

"Should cities also tax sugary snacks, not just drinks?"

Fallback Strategies to Practice

a

Circumlocution

Instead of "mechanism," try "what actually makes that happen" or "the steps in between."

b

Term substitution

Instead of "trigger" / "downstream effect," try "what starts it off" / "what ends up happening later."

c

Self-correction

"What I mean is..." / "Let me put that another way..."

d

Hedging

"It seems to set off..." / "This tends to lead to..."

Instructor note: use after a student is reliably producing the frame vocabulary. The argument frame provides the content — the task is circumlocution, hedging, not generation from scratch. This is a stress test, not a first attempt.

Week 4 Enabling Activities

Hypothetical & Conditional

This set covers the full six-activity family for Hypothetical & Conditional, organized as two tracks: 1a--1c build the Condition → Projected Outcome → Extended Scenario move in stages; 4a--4c test whether it has proceduralized. These supplement -- they do not replace -- this week's folder and the ESO/Frames Daily Protocol.

This Week's Frame — Hypothetical & Conditional (W4)

Condition

What must hold for this scenario to follow?

Projected Outcome

What would likely result?

Extended Scenario

And if that outcome holds, then what?

Key requirement: the extended scenario must go one step beyond the projected outcome. A response that states the condition and the immediate result but stops there is only two-thirds of the move.

Activity Index

1a. Single-Scenario Depth Ladder · 1b. Sentence-Frame Progression · 1c. 3-Interval Comparison & Paraphrase · 4a. 2-Box Induction · 4b. Silent Protocol & Brief-Back · 4c. Strategic Competence & Fallback

Single-Scenario Depth Ladder — "Scaffold the Scaffold"

Holds one low-stakes scenario constant while building the Condition → Projected Outcome → Extended Scenario move in four steps. Use before a student's first W4 attempt, or as remediation if responses stop at the first outcome.

ANCHOR SCENARIO (HELD CONSTANT ACROSS ALL FOUR ITEMS)

A country lowers its voting age to 16.

1

Surface

"If a country lowers its voting age to 16, what is the condition, exactly?"

State the condition precisely — what has to actually be true.

2

Surface → Deep

"What would likely result immediately from that condition?"

Add the Projected Outcome box. First-order result only — stop here for now.

3

Deep

"If the voting age drops to 16, more young people would likely vote in that first election. And if that higher turnout holds over several elections, then ____."

Complete the Extended Scenario — the second-order consequence, one step further than the first outcome.

4

Transfer

"What would happen if countries made voting mandatory for all adults?"

Full response: condition + projected outcome + extended scenario, no connector given.

Instructor note: 5--10 minute warm-up. A student who completes Item 4 without hesitation is ready for the Week 4 folder.

Causal Subordination → Concessive Subordination → Relative Clause & Appositive

Builds subordinate-clause complexity in three tiers using connectors that read as ILR 2+/3, not just connectors that are technically subordinating. Coordinating conjunctions (FANBOYS) are excluded -- and so are 'because' and 'so': both are grammatically fine, but they're exactly the safe, overused connectors that inflate a proficiency ceiling. T1 uses higher-register causal subordinators with more precision.

SCENARIO

A country lowers its voting age to 16.

T1

Causal subordination — given that / on the grounds that / considering that

Complete each sentence, naming one condition-to-outcome link.

- "Turnout among young voters would likely rise given that ____."
- "Election officials are willing to lower the voting age on the grounds that ____."
- "Some critics remain skeptical of the change considering that ____."

T2

Concessive subordination — although / while / even though

Hold the immediate outcome and the extended scenario in tension inside one sentence.

- "While younger voters might turn out modestly in the first election, the long-term effect ____."
- "Although the immediate outcome seems small, the extended scenario ____."
- "Even though critics doubt any short-term impact, sustained turnout over several elections ____."

T3a

Restrictive relative clauses — "Fact who ____, Fact"

Complete each sentence with a relative clause. Then combine them into one sentence using a subordinating conjunction of choice.

- "Young voters who ____ tend to develop lasting civic habits."
- "Campaign strategists who ____ begin targeting younger demographics earlier."

T3b

Appositives — "Fact, ____, Fact"

Compress the stakeholder's identity into a noun phrase and embed it as a non-restrictive appositive.

MODEL

"The lowered voting age, the initial condition that opens the door to younger participation, produces a modest bump in first turnout, while the extended pattern of civic habit-forming, compounding across several election cycles, eventually reshape issues campaigns prioritize."

Instructor note: 'because' and 'so' aren't FANBOYS, but they're the safe, overused connectors that flag a proficiency ceiling. T1 swaps them for 'given that' / 'on the grounds that' / 'considering that' -- same causal entry point, higher register from the first sentence. Move to T2 only once T1 is fluent. T3a the entry point — relative clauses are the simpler move. T3b compresses a full clause into a noun phrase — more demanding. Move to T3b only once is fluent. Both are stretch — optional for students still consolidating T1 and T2.

Comparison & Paraphrase Prompts

Connects conditional-projection vocabulary to comparative sentence structures, moving from a simple one-line comparison to a claim that explicitly extends one step past the first outcome.

COMPARISON PAIR

How the voting age policy's first-election outcome compares with its extended effect across several election cycles.

Target Lexicon — must appear at least once

contingent
on

were
[X] to
occur

in turn

absent
[X]

downstream

- 1

Surface
"In one sentence, compare the immediate outcome of lowering the voting age with its extended effect over several elections."
- 2

Deep
"Using contingent on, explain what the extended scenario depends on beyond the first election's turnout."
- 3

Transfer
"Write one complex sentence connecting the projected outcome to the extended scenario, using in turn or downstream."

Instructor note: score for lexicon use and whether the extended scenario genuinely goes one step beyond the first outcome — not for stance on lowering the voting age.

Visual Synthesis

Forces students to notice when a conditional claim's condition has gone unstated from grouped, unlabeled examples — no rule is stated up front.

Box A

- If the city extends the subway line into the suburbs, downtown traffic would likely ease during rush hour.
- If schools eliminate standardized testing, teachers would likely have more flexibility in lesson planning.
- If the company adopts a four-day week, employee retention would likely improve.

Box B

- Downtown traffic would likely ease during rush hour.
- Teachers would likely have more flexibility in lesson planning.
- Employee retention would likely improve.

TASK

Box B's claims could just as easily be simple predictions about the future — nothing marks them as conditional reasoning. What is missing from Box B that Box A has? Why does naming the condition explicitly matter for this week's frame?

Instructor note: this is a common failure mode at ILR 2+: students describe a plausible future without ever grounding it in the 'if' that makes it conditional reasoning rather than a guess. Let the student name what's missing before you confirm it.

Silent Modeling & Pre-Attempt Brief-Back

Separates rule comprehension from production. Students extract the frame's structure from a marked-but-unexplained model, then must plan out loud before they're allowed to attempt their own response.

PHASE 1 — SILENT MODELING

Read the response below. Three elements are marked [A], [B], [C]. No explanation is given — identify what each represents before moving to Phase 2.

[A] If the country lowers its voting age to sixteen — a change that would immediately add several million newly eligible voters to the rolls before the next election — [B] turnout among that age group would likely be modest at first, since first-time voters historically participate at lower rates than experienced ones regardless of age. [C] But if those sixteen-year-olds vote even once before adulthood, research on civic habit-forming suggests they become measurably more likely to vote for the rest of their lives — meaning the policy's real effect wouldn't show up in the first election at all, but in the turnout data twenty years later.

Key (reveal only after Phase 2). In the digital version, each move is color-highlighted. In print, use letter markers above.



[A] =
Condition



[B] =
Projected
Outcome



[C] =
Extended
Scenario

PHASE 2 — VERBAL BRIEF-BACK ("PLAN BEFORE YOU PRODUCE")

Before attempting your own response to the prompt below, say out loud -- or write in one sentence -- your plan for each of the frame's three moves. Do not begin your full response until you've stated your plan.

PROMPT FOR PHASE 2 ATTEMPT

"What would happen if the voting age were lowered to sixteen only for local city elections, not national ones?"

Instructor note: the brief-back is a planning checkpoint, not a rehearsal -- keep it to one sentence. This models a legitimate strategy: a brief pause to organize before speaking.

Fallback Scaffolding

Tests whether the frame's core move survives without its own vocabulary -- the ILR 3 skill of knowing what to do when the exact word isn't available.

CONSTRAINT

Restate the argument below without using the bolded words. Add hedging language as you restate.

Argument to Restate

If the voting age drops to sixteen, the **condition** is met for a new cohort of first-time voters to participate before adulthood. The **projected outcome** is modest initial turnout — first-time voters historically participate at lower rates. But the **extended scenario** is more significant: young people who vote once are measurably more likely to vote for the rest of their lives.

PROMPT

"What would happen if countries made voting mandatory for all adults?"

Fallback Strategies to Practice

a

Circumlocution

Instead of "condition," try "what has to be true first" or "the starting point."

b

Term substitution

Instead of "projected outcome" / "extended scenario," try "what happens right away" / "what happens after that, over time."

c

Self-correction

"What I mean is..." / "Let me put that another way..."

d

Hedging

"It seems likely that..." / "This could eventually lead to..."

Instructor note: use after a student is reliably producing the frame vocabulary. The argument frame provides the content — the task is circumlocution, hedging, not generation from scratch. This is a stress test, not a first attempt.

Week 5 Enabling Activities

Values, Heuristics & Bias

This set covers the full six-activity family for Values, Heuristics & Bias, organized as two tracks: 1a--1c build the Value → Assumption → Competing Framework move in stages; 4a--4c test whether it has proceduralized. These supplement -- they do not replace -- this week's folder and the ESO/Frames Daily Protocol.

This Week's Frame — Values, Heuristics & Bias (W5)

Value

What does this stakeholder believe is important?

Assumption

What must be true for that value to justify their position?

Competing Framework

What does a stakeholder on the other side believe instead?

Key requirement: the competing framework must reflect a genuinely different value system — not a restatement of the same value with different specifics, and not a strawman.

Activity Index

1a. Single-Scenario Depth Ladder · 1b. Sentence-Frame Progression · 1c. 3-Interval Comparison & Paraphrase · 4a. 2-Box Induction · 4b. Silent Protocol & Brief-Back · 4c. Strategic Competence & Fallback

Single-Scenario Depth Ladder — "Scaffold the Scaffold"

Holds one low-stakes scenario constant while building the Value → Assumption → Competing Framework move in four steps. Use before a student's first W5 attempt, or as remediation if the competing framework isn't yet a genuinely different value.

ANCHOR SCENARIO (HELD CONSTANT ACROSS ALL FOUR ITEMS)

A company uses AI software to screen job applicants' resumes.

1

Surface

"What value drives support for AI resume screening?"

Name one value only (for example, efficiency or standardized fairness).

2

Surface → Deep

"What has to be true about the AI system for that value to actually justify using it?"

Add the Assumption box — what must hold for the value to be a good reason.

3

Deep

"Supporters value efficient, standardized screening. Critics, however, value ____."

Complete the Competing Framework — a genuinely different value system, not the same value restated.

4

Transfer

"Should landlords be allowed to use AI to screen rental applicants?"

Full response: value + assumption + competing framework, no connector given.

Instructor note: 5--10 minute warm-up. A student who completes Item 4 without hesitation is ready for the Week 5 folder.

Causal Subordination → Concessive Subordination → Relative Clause & Appositive

Builds subordinate-clause complexity in three tiers using connectors that read as ILR 2+/3, not just connectors that are technically subordinating. Coordinating conjunctions (FANBOYS) are excluded -- and so are 'because' and 'so': both are grammatically fine, but they're exactly the safe, overused connectors that inflate a proficiency ceiling. T1 uses higher-register causal subordinators with more precision.

SCENARIO

A company uses AI software to screen job applicants' resumes.

T1

Causal subordination — given that / on the grounds that / considering that

Complete each sentence, naming one value.

- "Supporters back AI resume screening given that ____."
- "Hiring managers are willing to adopt the software on the grounds that ____."
- "Some applicants remain wary of the system considering that ____."

T2

Concessive subordination — although / while / even though

Hold two competing values in tension inside one sentence.

- "While efficiency-focused hiring teams welcome faster screening, applicants who value individualized consideration ____."
- "Although the system treats every resume by the same standard, critics who prioritize human judgment ____."
- "Even though supporters emphasize consistency, those who value contextual fairness ____."

T3a

Restrictive relative clauses — "Fact who ____, Fact"

Complete each sentence with a relative clause. Then combine them into one sentence using a subordinating conjunction of choice.

- "Hiring managers who ____ prioritize speed and consistency in screening."
- "Applicants who ____ argue that algorithmic decisions lack human context."

T3b

Appositives — "Fact, ____, Fact"

Compress the stakeholder's identity into a noun phrase and embed it as a non-restrictive appositive.

MODEL

"Hiring managers, the primary beneficiaries of faster, standardized screening, welcome the AI system's consistency, while applicants, bearing the cost of decisions made without human context, argue that efficiency was privileged over fairness."

Instructor note: 'because' and 'so' aren't FANBOYS, but they're the safe, overused connectors that flag a proficiency ceiling. T1 swaps them for 'given that' / 'on the grounds that' / 'considering that' -- same causal entry point, higher register from the first sentence. Move to T2 only once T1 is fluent. T3a the entry point — relative clauses are the simpler move. T3b compresses a full clause into a noun phrase — more demanding. Move to T3b only once is fluent. Both are stretch — optional for students still consolidating T1 and T2.

Comparison & Paraphrase Prompts

Connects values/bias vocabulary to comparative sentence structures, moving from a simple one-line comparison to a claim that explicitly names competing priorities.

COMPARISON PAIR

How supporters and critics of AI resume screening weigh the same efficiency-versus-fairness trade-off differently.

Target Lexicon — must appear at least once

underlying
assumption

competing
priorities

at
odds
with

privileges

on
balance

1

Surface

"In one sentence, compare what supporters of AI screening value most with what critics value most."

2

Deep

"Using underlying assumption, explain what a supporter has to believe about the software for their value to hold up."

3

Transfer

"Write one complex sentence connecting the two competing values, using at odds with or privileges."

Instructor note: score for lexicon use and whether the competing framework is a genuinely different value — not for which side the student takes.

Visual Synthesis

Forces students to identify how two reasonable positions can reach opposite conclusions from identical facts — no rule is stated up front.

SHARED FACTS (BOTH BOXES WORK FROM THIS)

A city is deciding whether to allow a new large retail store to open on the edge of downtown. The store would create 200 jobs and offer lower prices, but it would likely put several small, family-owned shops out of business.

Box A

- The store should be allowed to open — 200 new jobs and lower prices benefit far more residents than the small number of shop owners affected.
- Efficiency and broad access matter more than protecting a handful of existing businesses.

Box B

- The store should not be allowed to open — those 200 jobs come at the direct cost of family livelihoods that took years to build.
- A community's character and the people who built it deserve protection, even if it means slightly higher prices for everyone else.

TASK

Box A and Box B are working from the exact same facts. What value is each box prioritizing? Why do two reasonable people, looking at identical information, reach opposite conclusions?

Instructor note: Box A prioritizes broad economic efficiency; Box B prioritizes community continuity and protecting existing livelihoods. Neither box is wrong — that's the point of this frame. Let the student name both values before you confirm them.

Silent Modeling & Pre-Attempt Brief-Back

Separates rule comprehension from production. Students extract the frame's structure from a marked-but-unexplained model, then must plan out loud before they're allowed to attempt their own response.

PHASE 1 — SILENT MODELING

Read the response below. Three elements are marked [A], [B], [C]. No explanation is given — identify what each represents before moving to Phase 2.

[A] Hiring managers who adopt AI screening value consistency — treating every applicant against the exact same criteria, without the fatigue or mood swings that affect a human reviewer's tenth interview of the day. **[B]** That value only justifies the tool if the criteria themselves are neutral — if the algorithm was trained on data that doesn't quietly favor certain names, schools, or zip codes over others. **[C]** Critics start from a different value entirely: they believe every applicant deserves individualized human judgment, and that no amount of statistical consistency makes up for a process that can't explain, in a given case, why a specific person was rejected.

Key (reveal only after Phase 2). In the digital version, each move is color-highlighted. In print, use letter markers above.



[A] = Value



[B] =
Assumption



[C] =
Competing
Framework

PHASE 2 — VERBAL BRIEF-BACK ("PLAN BEFORE YOU PRODUCE")

Before attempting your own response to the prompt below, say out loud -- or write in one sentence -- your plan for each of the frame's three moves. Do not begin your full response until you've stated your plan.

PROMPT FOR PHASE 2 ATTEMPT

"Should universities use AI to screen college applications?"

Instructor note: the brief-back is a planning checkpoint, not a rehearsal -- keep it to one sentence. This models a legitimate strategy: a brief pause to organize before speaking.

Fallback Scaffolding

Tests whether the frame's core move survives without its own vocabulary -- the ILR 3 skill of knowing what to do when the exact word isn't available.

CONSTRAINT

Restate the argument below without using the bolded words. Add hedging language as you restate.

Argument to Restate

Supporters of AI resume screening hold a clear **value**: efficiency and standardized fairness across all candidates. The underlying **assumption** is that the algorithm's criteria are neutral — that it doesn't quietly favor certain names, schools, or zip codes. Critics operate from a **competing framework**: they believe every applicant deserves individualized human judgment, and that no statistic consistency justifies a process that cannot explain a specific rejection.

PROMPT

"Should landlords be allowed to use AI to screen rental applicants?"

Fallback Strategies to Practice

a

Circumlocution

Instead of "value," try "what matters most to them" or "what they care about."

b

Term substitution

Instead of "assumption" / "competing framework," try "what has to be true for that to make sense" / "what the other side believe instead."

c

Self-correction

"What I mean is..." / "Let me put that another way..."

d

Hedging

"It seems to matter most to..." / "This tends to conflict with..."

Instructor note: use after a student is reliably producing the frame vocabulary. The argument frame provides the content — the task is circumlocution, hedging, not generation from scratch. This is a stress test, not a first attempt.

Week 6 Enabling Activities

Synthesis & Judgment

This set covers the full six-activity family for Synthesis & Judgment, organized as two tracks: 1a--1c build the Tensions → Priorities → Judgment move in stages; 4a--4c test whether it has proceduralized. Because W6 is the spiral week, every activity also requires integrating at least one prior frame (W1--W5). These supplement -- they do not replace -- this week's folder and the ESO/Frames Daily Protocol.

This Week's Frame — Synthesis & Judgment (W6)

Tensions

What competing claims must be addressed?

Priorities

Which consideration carries more weight, and why?

Judgment

What is the most defensible conclusion?

Key requirement: every response this week integrates at least one prior frame (W1--W5) as part of naming the tensions or defending the priority. A response that only describes disagreement without committing to a priority is operating at ILR 2+, not ILR 3.

Activity Index

1a. Single-Scenario Depth Ladder · 1b. Sentence-Frame Progression · 1c. 3-Interval Comparison & Paraphrase · 4a. 2-Box Induction · 4b. Silent Protocol & Brief-Back · 4c. Strategic Competence & Fallback

Single-Scenario Depth Ladder — "Scaffold the Scaffold"

Holds one low-stakes scenario constant while building the Tensions → Priorities → Judgment move in four steps. Item 3 adds the spiral defense. Item 4 removes all support.

ANCHOR SCENARIO (HELD CONSTANT ACROSS ITEMS 1--3)

A country is deciding whether to adopt a universal basic income (UBI).

1

Surface

"What are the two competing claims in the UBI debate?"

Name one tension only.

2

Surface → Deep

"Which consideration should carry more weight here?"

Add the Priorities box. State which one wins — the defense comes next, not yet.

3

Deep

"If reducing poverty is weighted more heavily than short-term cost, the most defensible conclusion is that a country _____. Defend that weighting using a trade-off: what's given up either way, and why is one loss more tolerable than the other?"

Complete the Judgment and defend it with a prior-frame move in the same response.

4

Transfer

"Should countries replace their current retirement age with a flexible retirement window based on job type?"

Full response: tensions + priorities + judgment, integrating at least one prior frame of your choosing, no connector given.

Instructor note: this is the hardest week's ladder — expect it to take longer than 5--10 minutes. If a student stalls at Item 3, they likely need more practice with a specific prior frame (probably W2 Trade-offs) before the spiral defense comes easily.

Causal Subordination → Concessive Subordination → Relative Clause & Appositive

Builds subordinate-clause complexity in three tiers using connectors that read as ILR 2+/3, not just connectors that are technically subordinating. Coordinating conjunctions (FANBOYS) are excluded -- and so are 'because' and 'so': both are grammatically fine, but they're exactly the safe, overused connectors that inflate a proficiency ceiling. T1 uses higher-register causal subordinators with more precision. Unlike every other week, T2 and T3 must name the tension and resolve it toward one side using a prior frame's reasoning, in the same sentence.

SCENARIO

A country is deciding whether to adopt a universal basic income (UBI).

T1

Causal subordination — given that / on the grounds that / considering that

Complete each sentence, naming one priority — no resolution required yet.

- "UBI advocates prioritize poverty reduction given that ____."
- "Skeptics remain cautious about the cost on the grounds that ____."
- "Some economists support a pilot program considering that ____."

T2

Concessive subordination — although / while / even though

Name the tension and resolve it in the same sentence.

- "While critics worry about UBI's cost to taxpayers, that cost is more tolerable than continued poverty because ____."
- "Although a universal payment reaches people who don't strictly need it, the simplicity is worth that inefficiency given that ____."
- "Even though the program requires new taxes, the burden is justified rather than the alternative because ____."

T3a

Restrictive relative clauses — "Fact who ____, Fact"

Complete each sentence with a relative clause. Then combine them into one sentence using a subordinating conjunction of choice.

- "Advocates who ____ argue UBI eliminates poverty traps in the current system."
- "Skeptics who ____ question whether broad payments are fiscally sustainable."

T3b

Appositives — "Fact, ____, Fact"

Compress the stakeholder's identity into a noun phrase and embed it as a non-restrictive appositive.

MODEL

"The cost to taxpayers, a burden that critics call disproportionate at the organizational level, is outweighed by the security it provides to individual families living paycheck to paycheck — the same scale-based trade-off that makes redistribution difficult in most safety-net debates."

Instructor note: 'because' and 'so' aren't FANBOYS, but they're the safe, overused connectors that flag a proficiency ceiling. T1 swaps them for 'given that' / 'on the grounds that' / 'considering that' -- same causal entry point, higher register from the first sentence. Move to T2 only once T1 is fluent. Unlike other weeks, T3b here is not optional stretch — it's the clearest single-sentence test of whether resolution-plus-integration has landed.

Comparison & Paraphrase Prompts

Connects synthesis vocabulary to comparative sentence structures, moving from a simple one-line comparison to a claim that resolves the comparison and names the prior frame doing the work.

COMPARISON PAIR

How the security UBI provides to individuals compares with its cost to the broader tax base — and which consideration should win.

Target Lexicon — must appear at least once

outweighs

defensible

resolves

in light
of

on
balance

1

Surface

"In one sentence, compare the security UBI provides to individuals with its cost to the broader tax base."

2

Deep

"Using defensible, explain which side of that comparison is stronger and why."

3

Transfer

"Write one complex sentence that resolves the comparison — using outweighs or on balance — and explicitly names which prior frame (W1--W5) justifies your resolution."

Instructor note: score for lexicon use and whether the student explicitly names which prior frame justifies the resolution — not for which side they land

Visual Synthesis

Forces students to distinguish a resolved judgment from a restated tension — and to see the spiral requirement modeled in context.

SHARED FACTS (BOTH BOXES WORK FROM THIS)

A city is debating whether to close a beloved but financially struggling public swimming pool to save money, or keep it open by raising local taxes.

Box A

- There are good reasons to keep the pool open and good reasons to close it. Both sides have valid points, and the city needs to weigh cost against community value.
- Ultimately, this is a difficult decision that depends on what the city values most.

Box B

- The pool should stay open. At the individual and family level, it's one of the only affordable recreational spaces for lower-income residents — losing it would fall hardest on exactly the households least able to absorb the loss.
- At the organizational level, the tax increase needed is small relative to the whole city budget. Because the burden of closing falls disproportionately on one group while the burden of the tax is spread broadly, keeping the pool open is the more defensible choice.

TASK

What does Box B do that Box A never does? Why isn't "both sides have good points" a judgment, even though it sounds balanced and reasonable? Which prior frame is Box B drawing on to defend its priority?

Instructor note: Box A sounds thoughtful but never commits to a priority or conclusion — it's a restated tension wearing the shape of a judgment. Box commits, and defends the priority using a W1-style scale/stakeholder move. Let the student name both things before you confirm them.

Silent Modeling & Pre-Attempt Brief-Back

Separates rule comprehension from production. Students extract the frame's structure from a marked-but-unexplained model, then must plan out loud before they're allowed to attempt their own response. For W6, the model marks four moves, not three — the fourth being which prior frame is doing the work.

PHASE 1 — SILENT MODELING

Read the response below. Four elements are marked [A], [B], [C], [D]. No explanation is given — identify what each represents before moving to Phase 2.

[A] Critics argue UBI is too costly, while advocates insist the security it provides justifies the expense. **[B]** Between those two claims, the security argument carries more weight, because the cost of doing nothing — persistent poverty and its downstream strain on emergency services, healthcare, and lost productivity — is higher than the cost of the program itself. **[C]** Weighing the individual-level benefit of guaranteed income against the organizational-level tax burden — a W1 scale analysis — **[D]** the individual security outweighs the aggregate cost, since the burden is spread thinly across many taxpayers while the benefit is concentrated where it's needed most.

Key (reveal only after Phase 2). In the digital version, each move is color-highlighted. In print, use letter markers above.

	[A] = Tension		[B] = Priority		[C] = Prior Frame Used (W1)		[D] = Judgment
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PHASE 2 — VERBAL BRIEF-BACK ("PLAN BEFORE YOU PRODUCE")

Before attempting your own response to the prompt below, say out loud -- or write in one sentence -- your plan for each of the frame's three moves. Do not begin your full response until you've stated your plan. For W6: also state which prior frame you will use to defend your priority.

PROMPT FOR PHASE 2 ATTEMPT

"Should a universal basic income replace unemployment benefits entirely, or supplement them?"

Instructor note: the brief-back is a planning checkpoint, not a rehearsal -- keep it to one sentence. This models a legitimate strategy: a brief pause to organize before speaking.

Fallback Scaffolding

Tests whether the frame's core move survives without its own vocabulary -- the ILR 3 skill of knowing what to do when the exact word isn't available. For W6 only: the frame vocabulary AND the prior frame labels are off-limits.

CONSTRAINT

Restate the argument below without using the bolded words. Add hedging language as you restate. For W6: also avoid naming the prior frame you are drawing on (e.g. do not say 'trade-off' or 'scale'). The reasoning must be there; the labels cannot.

Argument to Restate

The UBI debate surfaces a genuine **tension**: individual security versus collective fiscal cost. The **priority** that carries more weight security — because the cost of persistent poverty, measured in emergency services, healthcare strain, and lost productivity, exceeds the cost of the program itself. The most defensible **judgment** is that a modest UBI, funded through progressive taxation, produces a net social benefit when the full accounting is done.

PROMPT

"Should countries replace their current retirement age with a flexible retirement window based on job type?"

Fallback Strategies to Practice

a

Circumlocution

Instead of "my judgment is," try "what makes the most sense here is" or "the strongest conclusion is."

b

Term substitution

Instead of naming a prior frame directly, just do the reasoning without labeling it.

c

Self-correction

"What I mean is..." / "Let me put that another way..."

d

Hedging

"It seems like the strongest case is..." / "This tends to matter more when..."

Instructor note: use only after a student is reliably integrating a prior frame by name in Activities 1a--4b. This tests whether the reasoning survives once all scaffolding language disappears entirely — a stress test, not a first attempt.